Bhakti-ratnakara

"The Ocean of the Jewels of Bhakti"

A poem by Narahari Chakravarti (Ghanashyama Dasa)

Translated from the Bengali

Translator's note

The *Bhakti-ratnakara* is a Bengali poem in fifteen "waves" (tarangas) by Narahari Chakravarti (Ghanashyama Dasa),
a Vaishnava of Vrindavana in the eighteenth century. At its centre are the lives of Srinivasa Acharya, Narottama
Thakura and Shyamananda, but through their story Narahari also tells of the Gosvamis of Vrindavana and of many
associates of Sri Chaitanya, describes the circuit of Vraja-mandala (the fifth wave) and of Navadvipa (the twelfth
wave), and quotes a great number of Sanskrit verses and songs.

Source. The second edition (Murshidabad, Radharaman Press, ed. Rasabihari Sankhyatirtha, 1912–1913) in two
scans, collated for tarangas 1–9 with the first edition (Berhampur, 1888); both are in the public domain. The
Gaudiya Mission edition (1960) was consulted only to check readings; its notes and translations of the Sanskrit
verses were not used. **Only the poem itself** is translated.

Numbering. The old editions do not number the couplets, so the numbering of the Gaudiya Mission edition (the
customary system of reference) is followed; couplets absent there are marked with a letter (371a), and omissions
are noted.

Principles. The payar couplets are translated line by line, without rhyme; tripadi stanzas, songs and Sanskrit
verses are numbered as single units. Corrupt passages and the sources of quotations are noted in the translator's
notes at the end of each taranga.

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Taranga 1. The Mangalacharana, Accounts of Various Matters, and a Brief Statement of the Birth of Srinivasa Acharya and Other Events

Verses of blessing and the glorification of the Lord and His associates; Gopala Bhatta and his family; Narottama and Lokanatha; Shyamananda; the disciples of Srinivasa; why the book is called Bhakti-ratnakara; the ancestors of Jiva Gosvami, Rupa, Sanatana, Jiva and Raghunatha Dasa; the books of the Gosvamis; the birth of Srinivasa Acharya (in brief)

1. *O beautiful Gaurahari, abode of the auspiciousness of kirtana, ocean of great sweetness, ever bestowing the rasa of bhakti, shining golden mountain of prema, remover of all anarthas, You whose form is so dear, abode of pastimes and delights, sole Lord of the devotees of all the worlds — O Prabhu, be gracious!*[1]

2. *O Sri Bhatta Gopala, bee at the lotus feet of the beautiful Gaura, sun dispelling the darkness of Mayavada, ocean of mercy, lord of the twice-born, O Prabhu! O son of the illustrious Venkata Bhatta, rich in the ornament of true and great bhakti, crusher of the disease of samsara, giver of joy to the hearts of the humble — protect me!*

3. *O bee at the lotus feet of Sri Bhatta Gopala, uniquely skilled in giving away the jewel of bhakti, embodiment of love for the beautiful son of Shachi — protect me, O Prabhu Srinivasa, best of the twice-born!*[2]

4. *I ever worship the branches of Prabhu Srinivasa, the wish-fulfilling tree of prema for Sri Krishna Chaitanya-chandra.*

5. *The treasure of the Vaishnavas, remover of all anarthas — the book Bhakti-ratnakara: hear it, hear it with joy!*

6. Glory, glory to Sri Krishna Chaitanya, the Lord of all,
who loves bhakti, whose form enchants the worlds,

7. the Lord of Lakshmi, the son of Shachi and Jagannatha,
the treasure of the life of Nityananda, Advaita and Gadadhara!

8. O Lord, the Vedas and the other scriptures sing Your glory;
who is not enchanted by these pastimes of Yours?

9. Sri Guru, devotee, shakti, prakasha and avatara —
in all these forms, O Lord, is Your play.

10. Thus the wise worship Your play —
and as instruction for others it is the cause of great good.

11. *Thus [it is said] in the Chaitanya-charitamrita:*
"I bow to the gurus, to the devotees of the Lord, to the avataras of the Lord, to His prakashas, to His shaktis, and to the Lord Himself, who is called Krishna Chaitanya."[3]

12. Guru, Krishna, devotee, shakti, avatara and prakasha —
in these six forms Krishna performs His pastimes.

13. Without mercy, who has the power to know this truth?
To others this play of Yours is inaccessible.

14. You are Svayam Bhagavan, the shelter of all;
do what is fitting — I am afraid to ask for anything.

15. Glory, glory to Sri Guru, the mine of the jewels of mercy,
the crest-jewel of those who give prema for Sri Krishna Chaitanya!

16. Glory to Nityananda-Rama, the ocean of mercy,
the purifier of the worlds, the friend of the poor and suffering!

17. You are the svarupa-prakasha of Prabhu Krishna Chaitanya;
You fulfil the desires of all [the devotees].

18. Glory, glory to Sri Advaita-deva, the merciful,
who destroyed the terrible suffering of these souls!

19. You are the avatara who is a part of Krishna Chaitanya;
who can describe Your glory, O Prabhu?

20. Glory, glory to Gadadhara Pandita Gosani,
the foremost of the Lord's shaktis: there is no end to your virtues!

21. Glory to Srivasa Pandita, the best of the Lord's devotees:
your life, rare even for the gods, is renowned!

22. Glory to Sri Svarupa — fulfil my hope!
Glory to Vakreshvara, Sri Murari and Haridasa!

23. Glory to Narahari, Gauridasa and Shuklambara!
Glory to Sri Mukunda, Vasu, Madhava and Shankara![4]

24. Glory to the great and noble Vidyanidhi Pundarika!
Glory to Vasudeva Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya!

25. Glory to the illustrious Gadadhara Dasa Pandita!
Glory to Jagadisha, Kashishvara and Bhagavan!

26. Glory, glory to Sri Paramananda Bhattacharya!
Glory to Krishnadasa Brahmachari, whose deeds are wondrous!

27. Glory to the brahmana Haridasa and to the son of the Acharya![5]
Glory to the lotus-eyed Raya Ramananda!

28. Glory to Lokanatha and Sri Bhugarbha, full of prema!
Glory to Sanatana and Rupa, the abodes of rasa!

29. Glory to Kashi Mishra, Gopikanta and Shashthidhara!
Glory to Abhirama, Vamshi, Saranga and Sundara![6]

30. Glory, glory to Sri Prabodhananda Sarasvati!
Glory to Sri Gopala Bhatta, the offspring of Venkata!

31. Glory to Raghunatha Bhatta and Raghunatha Dasa!
Glory to Sri Raghava, who dwells in the forests of Govardhana!

32. Glory to Sri Hridayananda, the jewel among acharyas!
Glory to Chiranjiva Sena and Sri Raghunandana!

33. Glory to Kanu, Dhananjaya, Vijaya and Ramai![7]
Glory to Sri Subuddhi Mishra and Sri Jiva Gosani!

34. Glory to Bhagavatacharya, Madhava and Shridhara!
Glory to Vrindavana Dasa, the ocean of virtues!

35. Glory to Krishnadasa Kaviraja Mahashaya!
Glory to Srinivasa Acharya, full of love for Gaura!

36. Glory to Sri Thakura Mahashaya Narottama!
Glory to Shyamananda, the charming embodiment of bhakti!

37. Glory, glory to all the devotees of Sri Chaitanya-chandra!
Who can tell how many they are — their names are the highest good.

38. Countless are Chaitanya's devotees, boundless their deeds;
Sri Krishna Chaitanya is the one life of them all.

39. The longing grows to tell the lives of the devotees,
full of prema-bhakti: the devotees' will is the [Lord's] delight.

40. By the will of the devotees Gaurachandra descended,
and He plays wondrously with the devotees without cease.

41. He whose end Brahma, Shiva and Shesha do not find —
such pastimes Gaura-raya performs in the age of Kali.

42. Of three kinds are Chaitanya's pastimes, the abode of bliss;
their names are the Adi-khanda, the Madhya-khanda and the Shesha-khanda.[8]

43. In the Adi-khanda it is chiefly the play of learning;
in the Madhya-khanda, Chaitanya's manifestation of kirtana;

44. in the Shesha-khanda, His stay at Nilachala as a sannyasi,
having entrusted the land of Gauda to Nityananda.

45. The crest-jewel of sannyasis, Sri Krishna Chaitanya,
together with Nityananda and Advaita blessed the age of Kali.

46. Prabhu Sri Advaita and Nityananda-Haladhara
are bodies non-different from Sri Gaurachandra.

47. Who can understand the doings of Nityananda and Advaita?
They always swim in the ocean of prema for Sri Chaitanya.

48. Their nectarean talks with each other are like quarrels;
whose heart is not soothed on hearing them?

49. Ah, ah, would that I could take all their troubles upon myself
and wander from land to land singing the virtues of them both![9]

50. Prabhu Gaurachandra, with Nityananda and Advaita,
plays in Sri Navadvipa in all kinds of ways.

51. All these pastimes of the Lord are streams of nectar;
in great bliss the devotees drink them without end.

52. The world becomes pure through Gauranga's pastimes;
one hostile to the Lord's devotees never gets a touch of them.

53. He to whom the Lord's associates show favour
is the one who dives into the ocean of these pastimes.

54. The pastimes are of two kinds, manifest and unmanifest:
now unmanifest play, now manifest play.

55. As in the manifest, so in the unmanifest,
the Lord plays with His devotees without cease.

56. The son of Shachi plays in Nadia for ever;
all the shastras clearly declare this.

57. *Thus [it is said] in the Chaitanya-bhagavata:*

"Even today Gaura-raya performs those pastimes;
some fortunate souls are able to see them."[10]

58. The Lord's abode, bhakti and associates are eternal;
whoever thinks otherwise about this is truly wretched.

59. *Thus [it is said]:*

"We eternally worship the one truth — Nityananda, Advaita and Chaitanya — eternally adorned with the brahma-sutra, shining in the eternal abode with eternal devotees and the eternal Bhakti-devi."[11]

60. With all the devotees of all the avataras,
Vrindavana-chandra as Gaura plays in Nadia.

61. Navadvipa and Vrindavana are one;
the Lord plays eternally in the forms of Gaura and Shyama.

62. The wretch who sees a difference between Gaura and Krishna
sees a difference between Navadvipa and Vrindavana as well.

63. For one whose life and treasure is Gaura-Krishna,
Navadvipa-Vrindavana is everything.

64. The blissful play in Navadvipa and Vrindavana —
its essence is known to one on whom the devotees bestow their mercy.

65. Would that I could take upon myself the troubles of such devotees of the Lord!
Now listen carefully to what I shall say.

66. Earlier I composed a mangalacharana to Sri Bhatta;
in that same order I shall present my account.

67. Sri Gopala Bhatta Prabhu is the root of the bliss of prema;
in every respect the treasure of his life is Gaurachandra.

68. Srinivasa Acharya is the king of bhakti-rasa,
the recipient of Sri Bhatta's mercy, the embodiment of prema.

69. The branches of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura
are all full of bhakti-rasa and known to the world.

70. The nectar of their names I shall set out in full;
Gauranga with His associates is everything to them.

71. Again and again I beg you: listen, friends —
make the feet of Krishna Chaitanya your all.

72. One who is exclusively devoted to the Lord has the Lord in his control;
this good fame of the Lord has spread throughout the world.

73. Sri Krishna Chaitanya Prabhu is the life of the devotees;
apart from the devotees the Lord's mind turns to nothing else.

74. By the Lord's will devotees are born in various places,
and when the time comes the Lord meets with them.

75. The play of the meeting of the Lord and His devotee
the best of the wise have described in various ways.

76. In whatever way they described it, all of it is true;
whoever raises false arguments about it perishes.

77. If you say, "In one account I see a different way,"
know that the agreement lies in the difference of kalpas.[12]

78. The devotee's will is stronger than the Lord's will:
the Lord knows how to honour His devotee.

79. One devotee comes and meets the Lord,
while to another the Lord Himself goes and meets him in his home.

80. The Lord met Sri Gopala Bhatta in the South
and in great mercy revealed Himself to him.

81. Here I shall tell briefly about the Bhattas:
Sri Gopala Bhatta is the son of Venkata.

82. Sri Venkata Bhatta lived in the South,
a distinguished brahmana, learned in all the shastras.

83. Trimalla, Venkata and Sri Prabodhananda —
the treasure of the lives of these three brothers is Gaurachandra.

84. Formerly they were worshippers of Lakshmi-Narayana;
by the Lord's mercy they became intoxicated with the rasa of Radha and Krishna.

85. During His tour of the South, Prabhu Gaura-raya
spent four months happily in the Bhatta's house.

86. Chaitanya-chandra's beautiful tour of the South
is described in detail in the Chaitanya-charitamrita.

87. Gopala Bhatta's name is not mentioned there;
about Venkata Bhatta's family it says this:

88. *Thus [it is said] in the Chaitanya-charitamrita:*
"A Sri Vaishnava named Sri Venkata Bhatta
invited the Lord with respect.[13]

89. He brought Him to his own house and washed His feet,
and that water he drank together with his whole family."

90. Elsewhere it is stated that Gopala is Venkata's son;[14]
when he drank the water from the Lord's feet, prema arose in him.

91. However hard he tries, he cannot keep still;
abundant pulaka sparkles on his body.

92. How beautiful is Gopala, how lovely every limb!
His charming complexion surpasses the champaka.

93. What a lotus of a face, what long eyes!
What brows, forehead and nose, what bright tilaka!

94. What ears and cheeks, what a curve of the neck!
What arms, what a broad chest, what a slender waist!

95. What knees and shanks, what exquisite feet!
His clothes and ornaments are incomparable.

96. Moment by moment Gopala's beauty grows;
who, seeing the wondrous radiance, can stay composed?

97. Having obtained the Lord of his life in his own home,
Sri Gopala, at his father's bidding, serves Him with great joy.

98. *Thus it is said by the ancients:*
"I praise Sri Bhatta Gopala, the best of brahmanas, the son of Venkata, appointed to the service of Sri Chaitanya Prabhu in his own home."[15]

99. The mercy the Lord showed Sri Gopala Bhatta
I am unable to describe here in detail.

100. Still, I shall tell a little of Gopala's life:
by his very nature he is ever devoted to the Lord's service.

101. The Lord's sannyasa did not please Gopala;
going into solitude, he constantly lamented.

102. To the Creator he speaks in a faltering voice:
"O Creator, why did you have me born in a distant land?

103. You deprived me of the joy of the pastimes in Nadia
and showed me the Lord in this incongruous dress!

104. The son of the king of Vraja, the Lord of Radhika's life —
you made Him accept sannyasa!"

105. Saying this he drowns in the streams from both his eyes,
heaving long sighs like tongues of flame.

106. And again he says: "Why be angry with the Creator?
I know it is only the fault of my own karma."

107. Having said many such things he fell silent;
Gaurahari knew what was in Gopala's heart.

108. Suddenly sleep overcame Gopala,
and in the guise of a dream Navadvipa appeared before his eyes.

109. He sees there the wondrous play of the Lord
and plays together with the Lord — there is no limit to his happiness.

110. Nityananda and Advaita, in the rapture of prema, embraced him;
and while they were saying who knows what, the sleep broke.

111. Agitated, Gopala looks in every direction;
he walks before the Lord and cannot calm himself.

112. Knowing that Gopala had come, [the Lord] rejoiced without bound
and became the beautiful dark one [Krishna] in the dress of a cowherd.

113. Gopala in solitude contemplates this beauty —
and at that very moment [the Lord's] body became golden.[16]

114. With the lustre of His form He enchants the worlds;
the knot of His curling hair falls down His back.

115. On His forehead is sandal tilaka, His brows are Kamadeva's serpents;
the glance of His long eyes steals the chastity [of wives].

116. He crushes the pride of hundreds of autumn moons;
in some new curve of His smile nectar pours down.

117. He wears incomparable cloth tucked in the cowherd fashion;[17]
His body, adorned with jewels, stands in a captivating pose.

118. A malati garland swings ceaselessly at His neck;
seeing this, Gopala was amazed at heart.

119. He falls at His feet and again lifts his gaze to the Lord —
and at that moment he sees the crest-jewel of sannyasis.

120. Prabhu Gaurachandra calmed Gopala
and gave him instruction which I cannot relate.

121. And He said further: "Soon you will go to Vrindavana
and meet the rare jewels Rupa and Sanatana.

122. The two of them will reveal what is in My heart,
and through your disciple it will spread throughout the world."[18]

123. Saying this the Lord took Gopala on His lap
and drenched Gopala's body with the tears from His eyes.

124. He said, "Keep all these words secret."
Supreme bliss filled Gopala's mind.

125. Seeing Gopala's love for serving Gauranga,
Sri Venkata Bhatta was overjoyed.

126. He gave Gopala over to the feet of Gaurachandra,
and he spends day and night in bliss with the Lord.

127. "After four months the Lord will leave" —
at the very thought the three [brothers] lost their peace.

128. Trimalla, Venkata and Sri Prabodhananda, all three,
reflect: "How shall we live without the Lord?

129. Who will joke with us?
Who will take us with Him to bathe in the Kaveri?

130. Who will sing sankirtana before Ranganatha?
Who will give us fallen ones that rare wealth of bhakti?

131. For whose darshan will countless people come?
Without the Lord all these houses will be empty."

132. So they speak, and tears flow from their eyes,
but they do not voice all the anxiety in their hearts.

133. After four months the Lord took His leave;
the three brothers weep aloud.

134. Sri Chaitanya departs from the Bhatta's house;
the Bhatta, rolling on the ground, falls at the Lord's feet.

135. The Lord embraced the three brothers
and spoke many words of consolation.

136. Having consoled Gopala, the Lord toured the South
and came to Nilachala to His devotees.

137. Then came the journeys to Gauda and to Vrindavana and back,
and meetings with many devotees dear to Him.

138. The crest-jewel of sannyasis, Sri Krishna Chaitanya,
blessed the souls of the age of Kali through His devotees.

139. By the devotees' wish He lived in Nilachala;
what is in the Lord's heart He reveals to His devotees.

140. Here, meanwhile, Sri Venkata Bhatta and his brothers, all three,
were deeply afflicted by separation from the Lord.

141. How Gopala was without the Lord of his life —
who can describe it? Only one who saw it knows.

142. At parting the Lord had embraced him
and commanded: "Soon your desire will be fulfilled."

143. On those words he constantly reflects:
"After how many days will the Lord take me to Vrindavana?"

144. Gopala is ever intoxicated with prema for Gauranga;
in expounding the truth of bhakti he is victorious everywhere.

145. Everywhere he reveals the glory of Gaura's qualities
and refutes Mayavada without effort.

146. Cultured people praise Gopala Bhatta:
"How did he acquire such learning?"

147. Some say: "Sri Prabodhananda took care of him
and taught him from an early age.

148. By his uncle's mercy he came to know all the shastras;
there is no one here as learned as Gopala."

149. Others say: "Great are Prabodhananda's virtues;
his fame as Sarasvati has spread everywhere.

150. Purna-brahman Sri Krishna Chaitanya Bhagavan —
apart from love for Him he knows nothing, even in dreams."

151. *[Thus it is said in] the Hari-bhakti-vilasa:*
"Gopala Bhatta, the disciple of Prabodhananda, who is dear to the Lord, gathers [the accounts of] the delights of bhakti, pleasing Raghunatha Dasa, Rupa and Sanatana."[19]

152. Supreme renunciation, a charming embodiment of affection,
a great poet, incomparable in song, music and dance —

153. such is Prabodhananda: hearing his verses everyone is filled with joy;
his greatness is boundless."

154. So, with hearts full of great joy,
people speak of the virtues of Sri Prabodhananda and Gopala.

155. Sri Gopala, the nephew of Prabodhananda,
is well brought up in every way and supremely kind;

156. seeing him, his father and mother feel great happiness,
and he is always absorbed in the service of his parents.

157. A venerable brahmana said to Venkata Bhatta:
"Your son is worthy in every respect.

158. Such a way of bhakti we do not see here;
what wonderful love in his service to you both!"

159. Hearing this, Venkata Bhatta with a joyful heart
tells of Gopala's conduct from his childhood:

160. how he was at the darshan of Jagannatha in Nilachala,
how inspired he was in studying grammar and the other sciences,

161. how he served the Purna-brahman Krishna Chaitanya —
all of it in order he told that brahmana.

162. Having heard, the old brahmana, glad at heart,
praised Venkata and went home.

163. Gopala's father and mother are greatly fortunate:
they gave their mind and life to the feet of Sri Chaitanya.

164. Having allowed their son to go to Vrindavana,
both of them, remembering the Lord, left this world.

165. After some time Gopala came to Vrindavana
and met Rupa and Sanatana.

166. The all-knowing Lord in Nilachala at that very moment
knew that Gopala had come to Vrindavana.

167. One day He set out joyfully from Mishra's house
to Gadadhara, [the servant] of Gopinatha.[20]

168. The feelings Gorachand has for Gadadhara
are understood only as the fruit of great pious merit.

169. What the relationship of Nityananda and Gadadhara is —
who has the power to tell even a particle of it?

170. How Gadadhara deals with Advaita —
whose heart is not soothed on hearing of it?

171. Srivasa Pandita loves Gadadhara Pandita
more than life and ever weeps over his virtues.

172. The bliss Prabhu Haridasa feels
with Prabhu Gadadhara — who can express it?

173. What wondrous love Gadadhara Pandita has
with Gadadhara Dasa — who can understand it?

174. Sri Gaurasundara is Gadadhara's life;
[the Lord's] play with Gadadhara cannot be described.

175. To the house of such a Gadadhara the Lord came
and sat down surrounded by the devotees.

176. Who can describe that unprecedented beauty?
Fortunate people gaze from all sides.

177. The crest-jewel of sannyasis, Prabhu Gaura-raya,
speaks to the devotees in sweet words:

178. "For a long time I have had no news of Vraja,
and I do not know what is happening in My heart.

179. I certainly want to send a letter there."
No sooner had He said this than a letter arrived from Vraja.

180. In the letter Sri Rupa and Sanatana wrote
of Gopala Bhatta's arrival in Vrindavana.

181. Hearing this, Mahaprabhu was very glad
and told everyone something about Gopala:

182. "On My tour of the South, with great joy in My heart,
I stayed four months in the house of Venkata Bhatta.

183. Gopala Bhatta is the son of Venkata Bhatta;
in a short time he became expert in all the shastras.

184. Receiving his father's order, Gopala joyfully
served Me in countless special ways.

185. Supremely merciful Krishna showed him mercy:
this is that Gopala Bhatta who has come to Vrindavana.

186. Rupa and Sanatana are as dear to Me as life;
as soon as he arrived they wrote Me a letter."

187. Hearing the Lord's very sweet words,
the devotees were filled with supreme bliss.

188. Absorbed in the virtues of Rupa and Sanatana,
the Lord sends a letter to Vrindavana by [a messenger].[21]

189. In the letter He writes to His dear Rupa and Sanatana:
"I am glad at Gopala's arrival.

190. Regard Bhatta Gopala as your own brother,
and send good news from time to time.

191. The books you have written and will yet write
will soon be spread everywhere.

192. The one who will distribute the jewels of these books —
I think he has already appeared by Krishna's will."[22]

193. With such a letter, giving [the messenger] clothes and other things,
He gladly sent him off in haste.

194. He came to the Gosvamis in Vrindavana
and handed over the cord, the kaupina, the outer cloth and the letter.[23]

195. The joy that came over everyone in Vrindavana
I cannot describe in detail.

196. Sri Rupa and Sanatana, both full of prema,
have a wondrous affection for Sri Gopala Bhatta.

197. In the Bhatta's mind arose the wish to compose a Vaishnava smriti;
Sanatana Gosvami knew of it at that very moment.

198. And in Gopala's name Sri Sanatana Gosvami
composed the Sri Hari-bhakti-vilasa.[24]

199. Gopala wished to serve a Deity —
and Sri Govinda gave a command to Sri Rupa in a dream.

200. Sri Rupa Gosvami loves the Bhatta as his own life;
he entrusted him with the service of Sri Radha-ramana.[25]

201. These matters will be set out more fully later;
Gopala Bhatta's doings are truly wondrous.

202. With Lokanatha, Bhugarbha, Kashishvara Pandita,
Sri Paramananda and the learned Krishnadasa —

203. how lovingly he dealt with them all
cannot be described with one mouth.

204. In Vrindavana, always with Sanatana and Rupa,
he delights in talk of Sri Krishna Chaitanya.

205. His heart is full of love for Sanatana;
in his wondrous friendship with Sri Rupa he is happy without cease.

206. The Bhatta's only life is Sri Radha-ramana;
he is ceaselessly absorbed in the rasa of service.

207. By his virtues he fulfils all desires;
seeing him, everyone in Vrindavana rejoices.

208. *Thus it is said by the ancients:*
"I bow to Gopala Bhatta, whose heart is flooded with love for Sanatana, who is distinguished in all things by his friendship with Sri Rupa, whose only life is Radha-ramana, who grants their desires to those who worship."

209. Of these events of Sri Gopala Bhatta's life
some tell a little, and others tell nothing at all.

210. Whoever, not grasping the essence, raises false arguments about this,
in his heart the seed of offence sprouts.

211. The great rasikas, the poets of former times,
though able to describe it, did not describe it:

212. thinking to themselves, "It will be described later,"
they leave it for the delight of all [the poets to come].

213. Thakura Vrindavana described the pastimes of the Lord,
but did not describe the tour of the South and other things.

214. He is Vyasa himself; who can understand his intention?
He says thus: "Vedavyasa will describe it later."[26]

215. Krishnadasa Kaviraja, humbly bowing to him,
described the tour of the South and the rest in detail.

216. Here and there he left [things] to be described
for the sake of the poets who would write afterwards.

217. So a worshipful guru, having happily eaten rice and other dishes,
leaves remnants on the plate for his disciple.

218. Such is the custom of poets, but there is no end to the describing;
give up false arguments and relish it, fortunate ones!

219. The lives of the Lord and of the Lord's devotees
the poets attentively describe in various ways.

220. Knowing that the devotees' will is strong,
the poets write addressing the devotees of the Lord.

221. Krishnadasa Kaviraja, greatly delighted,
wrote his book after receiving the command of many.

222. Sri Gopala Bhatta gladly gave his permission,
but forbade him to describe in the book anything concerning himself.

223. Why he forbade it — who can understand?
He always considered himself the lowest of the low.

224. The Kaviraja could not transgress his order:
he writes only his name and makes nothing else known.

225. Lokanatha Gosvami too gave such an order;
this I heard from the lips of old Vaishnavas.[27]

226. Others described a little of it in his absence;
truly extraordinary are the virtues of this Bhatta.

227. The Bhatta's play of learning in Vrindavana
I have not disclosed here because of the bulk of the book.

228. He wrote a commentary on the Krishna-karnamrita,
hearing which the Vaishnavas feel supreme bliss.

229. Sri Gopala Bhatta, noble on the path of pure bhakti,
moment by moment performs extraordinary deeds.

230. After some time Srinivasa came to him there,
and the Bhatta mercifully fulfilled his hope.

231. Having become his disciple, Srinivasa, by the Lord's command,
came to Gauda and revealed there the books of bhakti.

232. Through Sri Rupa and others the Lord revealed the shastras,
and to Srinivasa He gave the power to spread these books.

233. Sri Thakura Mahashaya, non-different from the Acharya,
proclaimed these two shaktis in a verse of his own.

234. *Thus [it is said] in a verse by Sri Thakura Mahashaya:*
"Through one shakti, headed by Sri Rupa, the Lord reveals these books; through another shakti, named Sri Srinivasa, He spreads them. When will He who mercifully manifested these two shaktis on earth — the ocean of mercy Sri Chaitanya — come before my eyes?"

235. Srinivasa Acharya, the crest-jewel of the knowers of shastra,
by spreading the shastras of bhakti made the earth rich.

236. By the Lord's will he accepted many disciples;
Ramachandra, Gokula and others are known to the world.

237. Ramachandra and Sri Gokulananda are abodes of prema;
in passing I shall tell a little about them here.

238. Ramachandra and Govinda are brothers;
their father is Chiranjiva, their maternal grandfather Damodara.

239. Damodara Sena lived in Shrikhanda;
his name as a great poet is known to the world.

240. *Thus [it is said] in Sri Govinda Kaviraja's drama Sangita-madhava:*
"In Patala Vasuki is eloquent, in heaven Brihaspati is eloquent; in Gauda Govardhana is generous, in Khanda — Damodara the poet."[28]

241. Damodara the poet was skilled in argument;
no one could get the better of him in any way.

242. A digvijayi, easily defeated by him,
in his chagrin cursed him: "Be without a son!"

243. Damodara appeased him in every way,
and he said: "You will have a daughter, blessed in the world.

244. From her two jewel-like sons will be born;
by their power all that is inauspicious will be destroyed."

245. To this worthy brahmana a daughter named Sunanda was born;[29]
day by day she grew, blessed with beauty and virtues.

246. All the women of Khanda praise her;
when she reached the age for marriage, they sought a bridegroom.

247. The greatly fortunate Damodara Kaviraja
gave his daughter in marriage to Chiranjiva Sena.

248. Fear of the bulk of the book arises in my mind,
so I cannot describe the wedding festivities in detail.

249. On the bank of the Bhagirathi is the village of Kumaranagara;
many Vaishnavas live there, a beautiful place.

250. In that village was the home of Chiranjiva Sena;
after his marriage he settled in Khanda.

251. What shall I say of the life of Chiranjiva Sena?
All the people of Khanda regard him as their very life.

252. A wise associate of Sri Chaitanya Prabhu,
his heart is ever mad with sankirtana.

253. Chiranjiva of Khanda is known everywhere:
he made the poor and lowly vessels of bhakti-rasa.

254. In the Chaitanya-charitamrita, where [the devotees'] meeting with the Lord is told,
Chiranjiva Sena of Khanda is mentioned.

255. *Thus [it is said] in the Chaitanya-charitamrita:*
"Mukunda Dasa, Narahari, Sri Raghunandana,
Chiranjiva of Khanda, and Sulochana."[30]

256. Chiranjiva Sena, highly learned in every way,
lives in Khanda with his wife.

257. His wife, devoted to her husband, is like Arundhati,
of the finest character and extraordinary conduct.

258. As were the father and mother, so was the son Ramachandra;
by his birth Ramachandra brought great joy.

259. From infancy his conduct was captivating;
men and women see in him their second life.

260. His form is full of great splendour, in beauty he is Madana;
in a short time he acquired great learning.

261. Seeing Ramachandra, wise people reflect:
"This is a portion of some god; it cannot be otherwise.

262. By his own will he appeared in a family of vaidyas,
and because of his human form no one can recognize him."

263. Many Vaishnavas feel:
"If this one becomes a Vaishnava, many will become Vaishnavas."

264. So many people say many things;
Ramachandra Sena draws all hearts to himself.

265. How Srinivasa Acharya made him his disciple
is a very long story; I cannot set it out here.

266. He received the title "Kaviraja" in Vrindavana;
of this I shall tell here.

267. Sri Paramananda Bhattacharya, a treasury of prema,
Sri Jiva Gosvami and other residents of Vrindavana —

268. all, hearing from his lips the verses he had composed,
with great joy gave him the title "Kaviraja".[31]

269. Ramachandra Kaviraja, full of all virtues,
is the one with whom Narottama Mahashaya is one in soul.

270. *Thus [it is said] in the drama Sangita-madhava:*
"On the bank of the celestial river, in the town of [...], from Sri Chiranjiva Sena — honouring brahmanas, devoted to Vishnu, well known [even] to the chief minister of the king of Gauda — and from Sri Sunanda was born the excellent Sri Ramachandra; he, the king of poets, became truly one with the illustrious [Narottama]."[32]

271. What the relationship of Ramachandra and Narottama is
I shall relate further on; here I shall say a little.

272. Body, mind, life and name — the two have but one;
so the name "Kaviraja-Narottama" spread.

273. Everyone says "Narottama-Kaviraja",
as if two words — like Nara-Narayana.

274. "Ramachandra-Narottama" is known to the world;
a double name arose to gladden everyone.

275. Both are supremely expert in all the shastras;
without effort they crushed great unbelievers.

276. Ever skilled in bestowing pure bhakti,
they are exclusive rasikas, wisest in all doctrines.

277. *Thus [it is said] in the same work:*
"We bow to these two, who became a pair through great mutual love: ever devoted to the Lord, who have crossed beyond samsara, foremost in the teaching of the Satvata-tantras, masters of all

conclusions, rasikas ever bestowing the rasa of bhakti, ornaments [of the world] who drive out unbelief."

278. What can I say of Sri Narottama's deeds?
He visited all the tirthas, a brahmachari from boyhood!

279. *Thus [it is said] in the same work:*
"A brahmachari from boyhood, who has seen all the tirthas, the best of the highest bhagavatas — Srila Narottama Dasa."

280. Who does not know his power?
He was born drawn by Krishna Chaitanya.

281. Narottama was born on the full-moon day of the month of Magha;
day by day he grew like the moon.

282. At home he became mature in every respect,
absorbed day and night in the virtues of Sri Krishna Chaitanya.

283. By the Lord's will he is the embodiment of prema-bhakti;
great royal wealth does not touch his heart at all.

284. Soon he thinks day and night:
"How can I leave home and become a renunciant?"

285. To Sri Krishna Chaitanya, Nityananda, Advaita and their associates
he offers his prayers, and tears stream from both his eyes.

286. In the guise of a dream the Lord with His associates appeared to him,
comforted His beloved Narottama and calmed him.

287. Suddenly a man came from the king of Gauda,
and his father and uncle went to the court in Gauda.

288. Taking this opportunity he deceived the guards
and somehow took leave of his mother.

289. His mother, most virtuous, was named Narayani;
her life was in her son; what can be said of her ways?

290. The mother lives carefree, cherishing her son,
and does not know that her son will leave home.

291. Narottama, meanwhile, in deep secrecy
set out, meditating on the feet of the Lord.

292. How fresh his youth, how handsome he is!
On the full-moon day of Kartika he left home.

293. Having visited many tirthas he came to Vrindavana
and became a disciple of Lokanatha Gosvami.

294. On the full moon of the month of Shravana, at an auspicious moment,
Lokanatha accepted Narottama as his disciple.

295. The life of Sri Lokanatha is truly wondrous;
since the occasion has come, I shall say a little of it.

296. He lived in the village of Talakhaida in the land of Yashohara;
his mother was Sita, his father Padmanabha Chakravarti.

297. *Thus it is said by the ancients:*
"I worship Sri Lokanatha Prabhu, the son of Padmanabha, possessed of the wealth of the service of Sri Radha-vinoda alone."

298. Padmanabha was very dear to Prabhu Advaita;
Lokanatha is the son of this old brahmana.

299. Even at home Lokanatha always lived detached;
giving up everything, he came to the Lord in Navadvipa.

300. Prabhu Gaurachandra showed him great mercy
and ordered him to go to Vrindavana quickly.

301. Such an order was not without purpose:
the Lord was soon going to accept sannyasa.

302. Having become a sannyasi He would go to Vrindavana —
that is why He wished to send him ahead.

303. Lokanatha understood these hints:
in a day or two the Lord would accept sannyasa.

304. "His beautiful curling hair will be seen no more —
how will those who love Him keep their lives?"

305. At these thoughts alone he was thrown into turmoil
and, weeping, bowed at the Lord's feet.

306. The all-knowing Lord embraced Lokanatha,
secretly comforted him and sent him off.

307. Lokanatha gave himself to the Lord's feet,
bowed to the Lord's associates and departed.

308. In sorrow he wandered through many tirthas,
and after some time he came to Vrindavana.

309. The Lord, meanwhile, who is subservient to His devotees, having accepted sannyasa,
went to Nilachala and saw Nilachala-chandra.

310. From there the Lord set out on His tour of the South;
hearing of this, Lokanatha went south.

311. From the South the Lord came to Vrindavana;
hearing of this, Lokanatha went to Vraja.

312. From Vrindavana the Lord left for Prayaga,
while Lokanatha, arriving in Vraja, was in despair.

313. He resolved to set out for Prayaga in the morning,
but in a dream the Lord comforted him and kept him in Vrindavana.

314. Lokanatha could not transgress the Lord's command
and lived unknown in the forests of Vraja.

315. After some time he met
Rupa and Sanatana — what joy in Vrindavana!

316. Sri Gopala Bhatta and all the other associates of the Lord —
who can tell how close he was to them all?

317. His affection for Bhugarbha is known to the world:
only their bodies were different from Lokanatha's.

318. Prabhu Lokanatha, accomplished in every way,
served Sri Govinda and the other [Deities] for some time.

319. Ever overwhelmed with prema, the very limit of renunciation,
he is renowned in the world for his wondrous greatness.

320. In the Hari-bhakti-vilasa Gosani Sanatana
named him in the mangalacharana.

321. *Thus [it is said there]:*
"Kashishvara shines in Krishna's forest, and so does Sri Krishnadasa with Lokanatha."[33]

322. And at the beginning of the book Sri Vaishnava-toshani
he named him for the sake of blessing.

323. *Thus [it is said there]:*
"I praise those dear to Vrindavana, who have taken shelter at Sri Govinda's feet: the illustrious Kashishvara, Lokanatha and Sri Krishnadasa."

324. Lokanatha wandered constantly through Vraja,
rejoicing at the sight of the places of Krishna's pastimes.

325. Near Chhatravana there is a village named Umrao;
there Sri Kishori-kunda is of incomparable beauty.

326. In that place he lived for some time in solitude,
and in his mind was the longing to serve a Deity.

327. The Lord knew that Lokanatha was yearning,
and came in another form, bringing a Deity.

328. Telling Him His name — Radha-vinoda — He handed Him over
and at that very moment vanished from there.

329. Lokanatha Gosani reflects to himself:
"Who gave me such a Deity, and where has he gone?"

330. Seeing Lokanatha troubled by his thoughts,
Sri Radha-vinoda says to him with a smile:

331. "I live in the forest by this village of Umrao;
here, at this Kishori-kunda, is My place.

332. Seeing your longing, I too grew restless:
who will bring Me? — and I came Myself.

333. Quickly give Me something to eat."
Hearing this, he sheds tears of prema without cease.

334. With great joy he quickly cooked and fed Him,
made a bed of flowers and laid Him down to rest.

335. For some time he fanned Him with leaves,
and with joy in his heart massaged His feet.

336. Body, mind and life he gave to the Lord's feet
and became absorbed in drinking the nectar of the sweetness of that form.

337. He quickly made a cloth bag —
it became like a temple for Radha-vinoda.

338. That bag became wondrously beautiful;
he keeps it always on his chest, like a necklace.

339. The villagers want to build him a hut,
but nothing pleases Lokanatha except the roots of trees.

340. Supremely detached, he accepted only
what was needed to keep himself alive — others cannot understand this.

341. After staying for some time at the kunda, he came to Vrindavana;
all the Gosvamis lovingly kept him with them.

342. For some time he lived in supreme bliss,
but then the burning fire of separation overwhelmed him:

343. Sanatana, Rupa and the others passed from sight;
his condition then cannot be described.

344. Day and night he weeps for the virtues of Sanatana and Rupa;
only by the Lord's will does life remain in his body.

345. At that very time Narottama came there
and joyfully served his guru as is fitting.

346. Pleased with his service, he gave him the mantra of initiation
and showed Narottama boundless mercy.

347. Sri Gopala Bhatta and all the other wise ones
regard Narottama as their second life.

348. There he received the name "Sri Thakura Mahashaya";
all of Sri Jiva's love for him cannot be described.

349. Srinivasa Acharya met him in that same place;
there is no end to the joy he felt.

350. There too took place the meeting with Shyamananda;
of him I shall tell a little here.

351. He lived in the village of Dandeshvara, prosperous in every way;
his mother was Sri Durika, his father Sri Krishna Mandala.

352. The best of the Sadgopa caste and most virtuous,
[the father] saw his all in Krishna and greatly loved the devotees.

353. The virtues of Sri Krishna Mandala and Durika
cannot be described for fear of the bulk of the book.

354. Formerly [the family] lived at Dharenda-Bahadurpur;
respectable people say that Shyamananda was born there.

355. Mandala lacked nothing in any way,
[but] after [his] sons and daughters had died, Shyamananda was born.

356. Shyamananda was born at a most auspicious moment;
whoever saw him even once was filled with great joy.

357. Seeing the radiance of his son, Krishna [Mandala] says to his wife:
"Take care of him — may Krishna protect him."

358. The women of the village say again and again:
"For now let his name be Duhkhiya (the Wretched One)."[34]

359. His mother and father raised him with anxiety;
that is why he was first named Duhkhi.

360. The joy at the ceremonies
of his first feeding with rice and his first haircut cannot be told.

361. He never mixed with other boys;
grammar and the rest he learned in a short time.

362. Day by day he grows, and all rejoice to see it;
truly wondrous inclinations appeared in him.

363. The lives of Gaura, Nityananda, Advaita and their associates
he listens to attentively from the lips of Vaishnavas,

364. constantly sings their virtues,
and tears flow from his eyes like the stream of a river.

365. He always drinks the nectar of the pastimes of Radha and Krishna
and is most diligent in serving his father and mother.

366. Seeing that their son had come of age, his parents say:
"Take initiation in the Krishna mantra from whomever you wish."

367. Hearing them, he says with joined palms:
"My master is Hridaya Chaitanya in Ambika.

368. He is a branch of Prabhu Gauridasa Pandita,
who is dear to Sri Krishna Chaitanya and Nityananda;

369. in his house the two brothers dwell in person.[35]
If I receive permission, I shall go there and become his disciple.

370. If you say, 'How will you travel to a distant land?' —
I have thought of a way:

371. many people from our country go to bathe in the Ganga;
if I go with them, there is nothing to fear.

372. Be kind, both of you, and give me your permission,
so that all my desires may be fulfilled."

373. Hearing their son's words they rejoiced
and, by the Lord's will, gave their son leave.

374. Having taken leave, he came to Ambika-nagara;
Sri Hridaya Chaitanya, seeing him, was pleased

375. and asked: "What is your name? Why have you come?"
He laid everything before his master's feet.

376. Mercy arose in Sri Hridaya Chaitanya:
his former name was Duhkhi — he gave him the name Krishnadasa.

377. That the name "Shyamananda" would be revealed in Vrindavana
he indicated by a hint, and the wise understood.

378. He became known as Duhkhi Krishnadasa
and was appointed to serve his guru's Deity.

379. Sri Hridaya Chaitanya Thakura, full of prema,
was greatly pleased with his service.

380. Having made him his disciple, he offered him to the Lord's feet;
Sri Shyamananda's desire was fulfilled.

381. *Thus [it is said] in the Shyamananda-shataka:*
"He whom people on earth glorify as the beloved disciple of Hridayananda and as the dear disciple's disciple of Sri Subala, the Lord's friend — may that illustrious crest-jewel of the kings of rasikas shine day and night in my heart, awakening a taste for the intimate sports of Sri Radha's Beloved."[36]

382. After some days [Hridaya Chaitanya], kind to Shyamananda,
commanded him: "Go quickly to Vrindavana."

383. Hearing these words, he pleads in distress:
"Prabhu, order me to stay near you."

384. Hridaya Chaitanya embraced him again
and, overcome by prema, said: "Go to Vrindavana."

385. Duhkhi Krishnadasa, weeping bitterly,
bowed at his master's feet and took his leave.

386. At the sight of Prabhu Nityananda and Chaitanya[37]
tears of prema welled up from both his eyes.

387. Lamenting long, he bowed to the ground
and took leave of the Lord's associates.

388. He saw Navadvipa and other places
and everywhere begged for the great wealth of prema-bhakti.

389. Crying "Sri Gauda-mandala!" he wails aloud;
tears pour down his face and chest.

390. The associates of Nityananda, Advaita and Chaitanya —
uttering their names, he weeps without end.

391. Again and again he prays to the Lord:
"May Sri Gauda-mandala be merciful to me!"

392. Who can fathom the mind of a great soul?
In passing I shall tell why he prays to Gauda.

393. Everyone calls Sri Gauda-mandala a chintamani:
by the mercy of Sri Gauda all desires are fulfilled.

394. *Thus [it is said] in a song (a prayer of Thakura Mahashaya):*[38]
"He whose wealth and treasure are Gauranga's two feet
knows the essence of the rasa of bhakti.
He into whose ears Gauranga's sweet pastimes have entered —
his heart has become pure.

395. In whoever utters Gauranga's name prema arises;
I give myself up for him.
To whoever weeps over Gauranga's virtues the eternal pastimes are revealed:
such a person is qualified for bhakti.

396. He who knows Gauranga's associates as eternally perfect
goes to the son of the king of Vraja.
He who knows the land of Sri Gauda-mandala as a chintamani
obtains residence in the land of Vraja.

397. He who plunges into the waves of the ocean of the rasa of prema for Gaura
is an intimate of Radha and Madhava.
Whether he lives at home or in the forest — he who calls 'Ha Gauranga!',
his company Narottama begs for."

398. Thus many great souls sing the glories of Gauda;
Shyamananda constantly meditates on the land of Gauda.

399. At his master's command, full of eagerness,
having seen many tirthas, he soon came to Vrindavana.

400. In Vrindavana he performs a wondrous sadhana;
at the sight of it everyone's eyes and hearts are gladdened.

401. He gave great joy to Shyamasundara —
and in Vrindavana he received a new name: "Shyamananda".[39]

402. Sri Jiva Gosvami, seeing his fine conduct,
kept him by his side and taught him the books of bhakti.

403. All the Lord's associates who lived in Vrindavana
rejoiced at heart on seeing Shyamananda.

404. All that Shyamananda does in Vrindavana
is only at the command of his gurudeva.

405. Hearing of Sri Shyamananda's fine life,
Sri Hridaya Chaitanya here [in Gauda] rejoiced at heart.

406. He writes in a letter to Sri Jiva Gosvami:
"I have entrusted my disciple Duhkhi Krishnadasa to you.

407. Fulfil all the desires of his heart,
and after some time send him back here."

408. And to Shyamananda he constantly sends word:
"Know that Sri Jiva is my second self.

409. Be careful in acquiring the jewel of bhakti,
and see that you commit no offence against the Vaishnavas."

410. Thus he always admonishes his disciple;
by the guru's grace Shyamananda is fortunate.

411. After some time, coming to Gauda by the Lord's will,
he accepted Sri Murari and others as disciples in Utkala.[40]

412. These matters are not set out in detail here;
boundless is his love with Sri Narottama.

413. In Vrindavana Narottama bathes in the bliss of prema;
by the Lord's will he came again to Gauda.

414. How he came to Gauda —
all of that will be described in detail.

415. Narottama's disciple named Sri Vasanta,
born in a brahmana family, a great poet and a learned man,

416. described in a song something of how Sri Narottama
went to Gauda, Vraja and Utkala.

417. *Thus [it is said] in a song (in any raga):*
"Prabhu Narottama is a treasury of virtues;
his most tender body surpasses a golden lotus —
I do not know which creator fashioned it!

418. Mad with prema for Gora, giving up royal enjoyments,
he is in supreme bliss in Vrindavana;
having found the priceless treasure, he gave himself
to the feet of Prabhu Lokanatha.

419. Lokanatha mercifully accepted him as his own,
and he set out for Gauda;
having toured Sri Gauda and visited the city of Nilachala,
he entered Gauda once more.

420. How much favour the Lord's associates showed him!
What wondrous songs he revealed!
Says this servant Vasanta:
he mercifully delivered the unbelievers and the asuras."

421. Thus all have described [his life] in various ways;
now hear what I shall say.

422. When Narottama came to Gauda,
Prabhu Lokanatha gave the command:

423. the service of the Deities of Sri Gauranga and Krishna,
service to the Sri Vaishnavas, and the Lord's sankirtana.

424. As he was commanded, so he applied himself:
he established the service of six beautiful Deities.

425. With all earnestness he is always absorbed in their service;
the very sound of those names soothes the heart.

426. *Thus [it is said] in a verse of his:*
"Gauranga, Vallavikanta, Sri Krishna, Vrajamohana, Radha-ramana, O Radha, Radha-kanta —
obeisance to You!"[41]

427. Who can tell how pure his conduct was,
serving the Sri Vaishnavas with body, mind and words?

428. Truly wondrous are his constant festivals of sankirtana;
in that ocean of happiness all bathe, down to the lowliest.

429. Gauranga's dear associates in Gauda
all rejoice at heart on seeing Narottama.

430. Sri Jahnava Devi, the daughter of Surya Pandita,
the beloved of Nityananda, worshipped in the world,

431. expert in bestowing the jewel of prema-bhakti,
is pleased at the very name "Sri Thakura Mahashaya".

432. Seeing his extraordinary prema and strong renunciation,
Sri Jahnava Devi was overwhelmed with great bliss.

433. Coming mercifully to the village of Sri Kheturi,
she gave everyone her darshan and gladdened them.

434. How many favours Srimati Jahnava Devi showed —
how can I, a worthless wretch, describe them?

435. Sri Thakura Mahashaya is supremely generous;
whomever he favoured attained every perfection.

436. By the Lord's will he accepted many disciples:
Ramakrishna Chakravarti, Ganganarayana,

437. Santosha and others — all became noble on the path of bhakti;
all of Sri Narottama's deeds are extraordinary.

438. Sri Govinda Kaviraja, full of joy,
described something of his life in a song.

439. *Thus [it is said] in a song:*
"Glory, glory, glory to Thakura Narottama,
the great king of prema-bhakti,
whose minister, one with him in body,
is Ramachandra Kaviraja![42]

440. Prema is the jewel of his crown, his ornaments the succession of bhavas,
with which every limb of his shines;
on the royal throne in Kheturi he sits,
and with him the assembly of devotees.

441. The books of Sanatana and Rupa, the Srimad Bhagavata
he examines day after day:
Radha-Madhava, the brilliant rasa of the Couple —
the essence of supreme bliss.

442. Enraptured by Sri Sankirtana as his only enjoyment,
he knows neither dharma nor adharma;
yoga, charity, vows and the rest flee in fear,
karma and knowledge weep.

443. The shastras — the Bhagavata and the others that give the treasure of bhakti —
he himself honours;
the Sankhyas, the Mimamsakas, the logicians and their like
tremble at the sight of his might.

444. The thieves who are non-devotees flee far from him
and do not show themselves nearby;
to the poor and lowly he gave the treasure of bhakti —
only Govindadasa is left deprived."

445. Govinda, Sri Ramachandra's younger brother, is full of bhakti;
learned in all the shastras, he is praised by all as a poet.

446. Sri Jiva, Sri Lokanatha and others in Vrindavana
felt supreme bliss drinking the nectar of his songs.

447. There they all gave him the title Kaviraja,
and the Gosanis of Vraja praised him greatly in verse.

448. *Thus [it is said]:*
"The fragrance of the garland of verses connected with the moon Krishna, brought from the sandal mountain — Sri Govinda, the king of poets — by the playful spring breeze, has intoxicated the bees that take shelter at the feet of the celestial tree, the illustrious Jiva, and has caused wonder to all in the forests of Vraja. What could be higher?"

449. Sri Jiva Gosvami in letters from Vraja
again and again asks him to send the nectar of his songs.

450. Sri Govinda Kaviraja, at the Gosvami's command,
sends his nectarean songs to Vrindavana.

451. These matters will be set out more fully later;
Sri Govinda Kaviraja is the life of all.

452. Whatever he describes becomes the highest nectar;
Narottama, the Kaviraja and others relish it.

453. Whatever the wise ask him to describe,
he describes at once with a mind full of supreme joy.

454. King Harinarayana, foremost among Vaishnavas,
knows no one but Ramachandra.

455. How he became a disciple and whom he himself made disciples —
of this I have not been able to tell here.

456. Harinarayana made a request to the Kaviraja,
and he composed for him a song on the deeds of Sri Rama.

457. *Thus [it is said] in a song (in any raga):*
"Glory, glory to Rama, to Rama, the joy of the Raghus,
the beloved husband of Janaka's daughter,
whose virtues are sung without end
by gods, men, monkeys, birds and night-roamers!

458. Glory, glory to Him, [dark] like durva grass, like a fresh cloud,
lotus-eyed, steadfast in battle;
at His right are the arrows, in His left hand the bow,
He is deep as millions of oceans.

459. Bharata holds His sandals,
Bharata's younger brother does not let go of the umbrella and the chamara;
Shiva, the Four-faced One, Sanaka and Sanatana
stand before Him with joined palms.

460. With joy in his heart the son of the Wind
serves the feet of [the elder brother of] Bharata.
Govindadasa has firmly settled in his heart:
[Rama is] Harinarayana's chosen God."[43]

461. So, with the permission of Sri Santosha Datta,
he composed the drama named Sangita-madhava.

462. Wondrously is the purvaraga of Radha and Krishna depicted in it;
hearing it, Santosha Datta was filled with supreme joy.

463. In passing I shall tell something of Santosha —
by this account the ears, mind and heart are satisfied.

464. On the bank of the Padmavati there is a capital —
the beautiful town of Gopalpura.

465. There live King Krishnananda Datta
and Sri Purushottama Datta, great of soul.

466. The elder is Purushottama, the younger Krishnananda;
the love of these two brothers is the people's joy.

467. Sri Krishnananda's son is Srila Narottama,
whose incomparable life I spoke of before.

468. Sri Purushottama's son, named Santosha,
is Krishnananda's nephew, skilful in affairs,

469. a minister of the king of Gauda, adept at caring for the subjects,
very powerful: others are subordinate to him.

470. In every way he increases everyone's joy;
very learned, he is always engaged in discussions of the shastras.

471. He is Sriman Narottama's brother and disciple,
pure in serving the guru, Krishna and the Vaishnavas.

472. *Thus [it is said] in the drama Sangita-madhava:*
"Sri Santosha Datta — a resident of the town of Gopalpura on the bank of the Padmavati, a great minister of the lord of Gauda, the best son of Sri Purushottama Datta, the younger cousin and disciple of the best of the Dattas, Sri Narottama Mahashaya — by him [at his wish] the drama Sangita-madhava, on the purvaraga and other pastimes of Sri Radha and Madhava, following Their manifest pastimes in a worldly manner, has been composed and, honoured with many gifts of jewels and other things, presented."[44]

473. *And again:*
"He who, binding Sri Radhika and Madhava together within with the cords — the qualities — of prema, brought Them outside through the lotus of his heart, manifestly, for the good of the world, and in his own home served Them, offering everything — who here is more pious than Santosha Datta? Enough [said]!"

474. *And again:*
"Oh! In Sri Gauranga, in the Beloved of Vraja, in Radha-ramana, in Radha-kanta — the manifest forms of Hari! What an assembly, what beauty, what service to the guru there was! Ah, apart from Santosha there is no other abode of joy."[45]

475. Seeing the truly wondrous deeds of Santosha Datta,
people vie with one another in singing Santosha's virtues.

476. Some say: "Someone must be helping him,
otherwise such wealth of bhakti cannot be obtained."

477. Others say: "The Kaviraja and Narottama must be
his helpers; hence his incomparable intelligence."

478. *Thus [it is said] in the drama Sangita-madhava:*
"He whose helpers are always the illustrious Kaviraja and Narottama — what wonder is it that he has such intelligence?"

479. The wondrous way of bhakti of Sri Santosha Datta
I cannot unfold here because of the bulk of the book.

480. With Govinda Kaviraja he has a great friendship:
in everything they are one, only their bodies differ.

481. In the village of Sri Kheturi, with all these dear ones,
the Kaviraja and Narottama spend their time joyfully.

482. I have told briefly of the relationship of these two;
from hearing of it love for Krishna is born.

483. How Sri Ramachandra served his chosen Deity
I shall relate in detail further on.

484. And now I shall tell what I mentioned before —
the story of Sri Gokulananda Chakravarti.

485. An associate of Sri Krishna Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
is the brahmana Haridasa Acharya, who removes misfortunes,

486. expert in bestowing the great jewel of prema-bhakti,
day and night intoxicated with the rasa of sankirtana.

487. His sons are Gokulananda and Shridasa;
from infancy they drew all hearts.

488. Without effort they became expert in all the shastras,
ever intoxicated with the bliss of sankirtana.

489. What shall I say of the greatness of Sri Gokulananda,
the very limit of Srinivasa Acharya's mercy?

490. As his father commanded Gokula, so he did:
he became a disciple and was devoted to his guru's feet.

491. Such too is the way of bhakti of the most learned Shridasa;
you will learn this wondrous story in detail further on.

492. Srinivasa Acharya, supremely merciful,
spends his time happily with these disciples.

493. He always teaches the truth of bhakti,
intoxicating the world with the virtues of Sri Krishna Chaitanya.

494. Srinivasa Acharya is the Lord's beloved servant;
his fame has filled the earth and the sky.

495. Captivating is the story of Srinivasa's birth and the rest;
the Vaishnavas always long to hear it.

496. I have not understood the Vaishnavas' design at all:
they commanded such a fool as me to describe it.

497. Holding in my heart the strength of their command,
I shall tell what I can — listen with joy.

498. Whoever wishes to hear of Srinivasa's life,
with him Gaura, the son of the king of Vraja, is well pleased.

499. Whoever rejoices at heart on hearing this,
to him Prabhu Nityananda and Sri Advaita are merciful.

500. Prabhu Gadadhara, Srivasa and the other devotees
give the wealth of bhakti to whoever is attached to this.

501. But whoever has no faith in his life,
for him all of this leads to utter ruin.

502. Listen, all of you, to the life of Srinivasa —
without effort all your desires will be fulfilled.

503. And whatever else I describe here in passing —
hearing all of it, your great joy will increase.

504. It is so sweet that at its mere touch upon the ear
even those turned away will easily turn [to the Lord].

505. Again and again I beg you, listeners:
relish this book without cease.

506. The wise named this book Bhakti-ratnakara;
in it are various "waves", most captivating.

507. Placing on your head the lotus feet of the assembly of the Sri devotees,
dive always into this Bhakti-ratnakara.[46]

508. Everyone says that bhakti is the property of the devotees;
if the devotees give it, you obtain this jewel of bhakti.

509. Glory, glory to Bhakti-devi! Be merciful to the wretched:
no desire is fulfilled without the touch of bhakti.

510. Even if for many lives one performs various sadhanas,
the wealth of bhakti at Krishna's feet still remains out of reach.

511. Whoever longs to obtain that wealth at the Lord's feet,
let him relish the rasa of bhakti without cease.

512. Keep the jewel of bhakti carefully in your heart:
all the shastras sing that bhakti is the chief of all.

513. *Thus [it is said]:*
"Liberation is easily obtained through knowledge, enjoyment through the merit of sacrifices and the like; but this Hari-bhakti is hard to attain even by thousands of sadhanas."[47]

514. Who is able to tell the greatness of bhakti?
To relish the rasa of bhakti Chaitanya descended.

515. Would that I could take upon myself all the troubles of such an Avatara:
He made the lowest worthy of bhakti for Krishna!

516. Otherwise [Krishna] keeps this jewel of bhakti hidden
and never gives it, putting people off with enjoyment and liberation.

517. *Thus [it is said] in the Srimad Bhagavatam:*
"O King, Mukunda was for you and for the Yadus the Lord, guru, Deity, beloved, head of the family, and at times even a servant. Yes, that is so, my dear: Bhagavan Mukunda grants liberation

to those who worship Him, but bhakti-yoga only rarely."[48]

518. Bhakti, inaccessible even to Brahma — who attains it?
It became easy to attain by the mercy of Krishna Chaitanya.

519. Prabhu Nityananda is non-different from Balarama;
the avatara of Maha-Vishnu bears the name Sri Advaita.

520. Ah, ah, how wondrous the mercy of these two!
They filled the world with an ocean of bhakti.

521. Sri Gadadhara Pandita and the other shaktis of the Lord —
to whom did they not mercifully give bhakti for Krishna?

522. Srivasa and all the other devotees of the Lord
distributed the wealth of bhakti in great bliss.

523. Who can describe the virtues of Gora, the giver of bhakti?
He gives it Himself and makes everyone give it.

524. Placing devotees in various places,
He made known the supreme and rarest bhakti.

525. To Rupa and Sanatana He gave the western country,
and there they revealed [bhakti] on the authority of the shastras of bhakti.

526. They wrote the book Sri Hari-bhakti-vilasa,
in which hundreds of thousands of limbs of bhakti are revealed,

527. and the mighty book Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu,
on hearing which the devotees' hearts are filled with joy.

528. These two great warriors are the beloved of the Lord and of the devotees;
by merely remembering them one obtains bhakti for Krishna.

529. Sri Jiva Gosvami and all the other great souls,
by revealing the shastras of bhakti, conquered the world.

530. Who can describe the virtues of Sri Jiva Gosani,
upon whom rests the full mercy of Sanatana Gosvami?

531. The life of Sri Sanatana is truly wondrous;
he loves the Srimad Bhagavatam beyond measure.

532. In his early youth, in a dream, a venerable brahmana
with joy in his heart gives him the Srimad Bhagavatam.

533. On waking, Sanatana was agitated —
[and in waking life] that same brahmana lovingly handed him the Srimad Bhagavatam.

534. Having received the Sri Bhagavata, with great joy at heart
my master sank into the ocean of the nectar of prema.

535. How he relished the meaning of the Srimad Bhagavatam
he revealed in the Sri Vaishnava-toshani.

536. Of Sri Sanatana's past I shall speak briefly;
Sri Jiva Gosvami set it out in detail in the Toshani.

537. *Thus [it is said] in the Laghu-toshani:*
"Those who in early youth received the Sri Bhagavata in a dream, and in the morning, awake, from the very brahmana they had seen in the dream,

538. *and sank into the great ocean of the nectar of prema for Bhagavan — this writing is truly theirs, of those called Sri Sanatana.*

539. *Having offered it, Jiva, whose life is their feet, wishing to say something more, now offers this."*[49]

540. Seven ancestors of Sri Jiva Gosvami are known;
beginning from the first, I shall name them all.

541. Sri Sarvajna, named Jagadguru, a king among brahmanas,
greatly venerated, [a follower] of the Yajurveda, of the Bharadvaja lineage,

542. a teacher of all the Vedas, of great prowess,
was king of the land of Karnata, and none was his equal.

543. All kings always honoured him;
how wealthy he was — who can tell?

544. His son Aniruddha-deva was like Indra;
his fame, the best of all, rivalled the moon.

545. Honoured by kings, a knower of the Vedas, wealthy,
he had two queens, famed on earth.

546. He had two sons, Rupeshvara and Harihara,
whose many virtues were known everywhere.

547. The elder son, Rupeshvara, was expert in the shastras;
the younger, Harihara, was highly skilled in arms.

548. Having divided the kingdom and entrusted it to the two of them,
the father attained the abode of Sri Krishna.

549. After some time, gathering men,
the younger seized the elder's kingdom.

550. Having lost his kingdom, Rupeshvara with his wife
came on eight horses to the eastern country.

551. Enjoying the friendship of Sri Shikhareshvara,
Rupeshvara-deva settled there.

552. Sri Rupeshvara's son was named Padmanabha;
he was beautiful and incomparable in all virtues.

553. In the study of the Yajurveda with its angas and the rest
his wondrous fame was known to the world.

554. How wondrous is the life of Padmanabha-deva!
He always rejoiced in love for Sri Jagannatha.

555. From the land of King Shikhara, Padmanabha
came to the bank of the Ganga, wishing to settle there.

556. The great soul settled in the village of Navahatta,
which all people call Naihati.[50]

557. There Padmanabha-deva, with great joy in his heart,
diligently worships the form of Sri Purushottama.

558. Performing sacrifices and festivals, he was in supreme bliss;
eighteen daughters and five sons were born to him:

559. Sri Purushottama, Jagannatha, Narayana,
Murari and Mukunda — these five sons.

560. The eldest was Purushottama, the youngest of all Mukunda;
skilful in everything, with the best of virtues.

561. Sri Mukunda-deva's son was Sri Kumara,
the lamp of the brahmana family, supremely pure in conduct.

562. He always performs sacrifices and other rites in seclusion
and greatly fears the touch of people of bad conduct.

563. If ever he chances to see a yavana,
he performs atonement and takes no food.

564. Anxiety arose in his mind on account of his kinsmen,
and he at once left the village of Navahatta.

565. With his people he went in haste to the land of Vanga
and settled in the village of Bakla-Chandradvipa.[51]

566. In Yashohara there is a village named Fatehabad;
for his journeys back and forth he made a dwelling there.

567. Many children were born to Kumara-deva;
among them three sons, the life of the Vaishnavas:

568. Sanatana, Rupa and Sri Vallabha — these three;
they brought their lineage great honour in this world and the next.

569. *Thus [it is said] in the same work:*
"He whose triple wish-fulfilling creeper — the tongue — streaming nectar in the beautiful pada-krama, dances like a bee; whose feet were honoured by the assembly of kings — the king of Karnata, Sri Sarvajna Jagadguru, chief of the Bharadvaja lineage, shone on earth.

570. *The son of that king, while he ruled the earth — whose fame rivalled the moon, equal in might to the lord of the gods, honoured by all kings, the sole repository of the whole Yajurveda, wealthy — became famous on earth by the name Aniruddha-deva.*

571. *From the two queens of that renowned king were born sons, treasuries of virtue, named Rupeshvara and Harihara; the first, impelled by his own nature, attained great strength in the many shastras, the other in arms.*

572. *On the day of his departure to the abode of the Enemy of Madhu the father divided his kingdom and gave it to Rupeshvara and Harihara; but the younger, Harihara, drove from his kingdom his elder, Rupeshvara, the ornament of a noble family.*

573. *Sri Rupeshvara-deva, thus deprived of his kingdom by enemies, went gradually with his wife on eight horses to the eastern country; living there happily in friendship in the domain of Shikhareshvara, the blessed one begot a son, a treasury of virtues, named Sri Padmanabha.*

574. *On whose tongue the Yajurveda with its angas and all the Upanishads in their fullness clearly danced, whose heart rejoiced in love for Jagannatha — into whose ears has [the fame] of that son of King Rupeshvara not come?*

575. *The crown of virtues, giving up the wish to live in the land of Shikhara and eager to dwell on the bank of the shining celestial river, the accomplished Padmanabha, honoured by King Danujamardana, in time settled in Navahatta.*[52]

576. *While he worshipped there the form of Sri Purushottama with splendid festivals, five sons were born to him together with eighteen daughters: the first Purushottama, then Jagannatha, the steadfast Narayana, Srila Murari of excellent virtues, and the accomplished Sriman Mukunda.*

577. *From that Mukunda was born the best of brahmanas named Sriman Kumara; meeting with some hostility, he went with his family to Vanga. Among his sons were born three, dearest to the great Vaishnavas, who made their lineage greatly honoured both in this world and in the next."*

578. Sanatana, Rupa and Sri Vallabha are kings among devotees;
the eldest of all is Sanatana, his younger brother Sri Rupa,

579. and the youngest of all is Sri Vallabha, full of prema;
Sri Jiva Gosvami is his son.

580. How the three brothers lived at home
I cannot describe for fear of the bulk of the book.

581. Sanatana and Rupa were great ministers in every respect:
the king heard of them from the lips of respectable people.

582. The king of Gauda, a yavana ruling many lands,
summoned Sanatana and Rupa and gave them the burden of government.

583. For fear of the mlechchhas they accepted the post,
and through their efforts his kingdom grew.

584. The delighted king gave them separate estates,
and they enjoyed them, paying only a small tax.

585. They settled in Gauda, in the village of Ramakeli;
the very limit of wealth, a truly wondrous splendour!

586. To the assembly of Sanatana and Rupa, who were like Indra,
knowers of the shastras come from various lands.

587. Singers, musicians, dancers and poets
from every country are constantly in their service.

588. They spend a great deal of money without cease,
and no one is ever left without honour.

589. Both always occupy themselves with all the shastras
and refute and establish [doctrines] without effort.

590. An interpretation of the nyaya-sutras that anyone made of his own
is established only when Sanatana and Rupa have heard it.

591. So all, convinced in every way,
joyfully sing the virtues of Sanatana and Rupa.

592. The fame of their virtues spread everywhere;
brahmanas came from Karnata and other lands.

593. To the brahmanas from their native country Sanatana and Rupa
gave all of them places to live near the Ganga.

594. The village where the community of Bhattas lives is called Bhattavati;
all there are knowers of the shastras, incomparable in all doctrines.

595. With those brahmanas in the village of Ramakeli
they joyfully carry out all their worldly affairs.

596. How Rupa and Sanatana honour
the communities of Vaishnavas cannot be described.

597. How many brahmanas come from Navadvipa,
and how they honour them all, I cannot tell.

598. Sri Sanatana's guru is Vidya-vachaspati;
from time to time he stayed in the village of Ramakeli.

599. Under him [Sanatana] studied all the shastras;
what his devotion to his guru was cannot be told.

600. In his commentary on the Tenth Canto Sanatana
wrote his guru's name for the sake of blessing.

601. *Thus [it is said] in the commentary on the Tenth Canto:*
"I bow to my gurus — Bhattacharya Sarvabhauma and Vidya-vachaspati — and to
Vidya-bhushana, the ornament of the land of Gauda.

602. *I bow to Sri Paramananda Bhattacharya, the lover of rasa, and also to Ramabhadra and*
Vani-vilasa, my instructors."[53]

603. How Sanatana and Rupa performed their sadhana —
who is able to tell of it in detail?

604. Near their house, in a very secluded place,
there was a kadamba grove, and in it Radha-kunda and Shyama-kunda.

605. There they meditate on the pastimes of Vrindavana;
they cannot restrain themselves, and tears flow from their eyes without cease.

606. They are devoted to the service of the Deity Madanamohana;
how much shall I tell of their constant words of grief?

607. Sri Krishna Chaitanya-chandra plays in Nadia,
and they always yearn to see Him.

608. Thinking of how purely their fathers and grandfathers lived,
they condemn themselves in their hearts:

609. "Our father, on seeing a yavana, performed atonement,
and we are in constant association with yavanas.

610. Fawning, we go to the houses of yavanas" —
and therefore they consider themselves equal to mlechchhas.

611. Their inner disposition is not at all like that,
but in this they consider themselves the lowest of the low.

612. When they sink into the ocean of humility,
they consider themselves lower than mlechchhas and the rest.

613. With the low-born there is always low dealing:
that is why they speak of themselves as low-born.

614. Though kings among brahmanas, with great grief in their hearts
they never think of themselves as brahmanas.

615. Such is the way of those on whom Sri Chaitanya's mercy rests:
never do they think of themselves as high.

616. Always, with unchanging feeling, they consider themselves low;
Sri Krishna Chaitanya knows the truth about His devotee.

617. The Purna-brahman, the eternal Sri Krishna Chaitanya —
as He humbles Himself, so no one else can.

618. His devotees are always immersed in the rasa of humility;
what bliss lies in humility Gaura-raya knows.

619. What was in the hearts of Sanatana and Rupa
Sri Krishna Chaitanya-chandra came to know.

620. The Lord knows many ways to meet His devotee:
He came to Ramakeli on the way to Vrindavana.

621. Hundreds of thousands of people run to see the Lord;
even yavanas joyfully sing the Lord's virtues.

622. The hearts of Sanatana and Rupa overflow with joy;
coming secretly, they fall at the Lord's feet.

623. How they pleaded, holding straw between their teeth —
at the mere telling of it everyone's heart breaks.

624. The Lord, who loves His devotees, cannot restrain Himself:
at the humility of Sanatana and Rupa His soul weeps.

625. In the book Chaitanya-charitamrita it is written:
"Give up this humility — your humility breaks My heart."[54]

626. How they humbled themselves is partly told there;
for fear of the bulk of the book I do not write it here.

627. The best in every respect, they humble themselves thus:
"low, mlechchhas, sinners" — so they revile themselves.

628. The brahmanas were amazed, not understanding this secret:
the Lord was teaching people through His devotees.

629. O brother! Who can understand the Lord's heart?
He is subject to His devotees, revealing the devotees' virtues.

630. Through Ramananda He revealed the crushing of Kandarpa's pride,
through Damodara He revealed impartiality,

631. through Haridasa He showed forbearance,
through Sanatana and Rupa He revealed humility.

632. Control of the senses, impartiality, forbearance and humility —
these four utmost limits Sri Chaitanya revealed.[55]

633. The humility of Sanatana and Rupa I cannot understand;
fools argue about it in various ways.

634. Whoever wishes to go to the most terrible hell,
let him commit such offences as false arguments and the like.

635. Having shown mercy to Sanatana and Rupa with their companions,
Gaurahari set out from Ramakeli.

636. What happiness flooded Sanatana, Rupa
and Sri Vallabha, the three brothers, cannot be told.

637. Keshava Chhatri and all the other wise men,
seeing the Lord, found the fulfilment [of their lives].

638. Sri Jiva and others saw the Lord in secret;
this I heard from the lips of very old people.[56]

639. Soon Sri Jiva's intellect became wondrous:
in grammar and the other shastras he attained great mastery.

640. Sanatana and Rupa, looking upon their nephew,
show him great mercy and affection.

641. Who can understand the life of Sri Jiva?
He thinks constantly of the beauty of the Lord's form.

642. He studies the shastras with his teachers without cease;
seeing this, everyone is greatly pleased at heart.

643. All say: "He was born from a portion of some god —
otherwise how could he have reached such mastery so soon?"

644. "As beautiful as Sanatana, Rupa and Vallabha are,
so captivating is the beauty of Sri Jiva."

645. Many things are said thus — I cannot describe them all;
would that I could take upon myself the troubles of such a Sri Jiva!

646. Sanatana and Rupa, great ministers in every respect,
devised a way to leave their great affairs.

647. To meet the Lord they performed a purashcharana
and appointed men to bring news of the Lord.

648. First they cautiously sent off their households —
some to Chandradvipa, some to Fatehabad.

649. Sri Rupa with Vallabha, boarding a boat,
joyfully went home with great wealth.

650. All the wealth he distributed to brahmanas, Vaishnavas and others,
and, hearing that the Lord had gone to Vraja, set out.

651. From Vrindavana the Lord came to Prayaga;
coming to Prayaga, Rupa and Vallabha met Him.

652. In supreme bliss Gaurahari showed them mercy
and carefully sent them off quickly to Vrindavana.

653. Sanatana conducted the royal affairs through other people,
while he himself at home occupied himself with examining the shastras:

654. gathering twenty or thirty bhattacharyas and pandits,
he sits in assembly and discusses the Bhagavata.

655. In the Chaitanya-charitamrita all this is described:
Sanatana went to Kashi and met the Lord.[57]

656. Who can describe the mercy the Lord showed Sanatana,
from whose body He wiped away the dirt with His own hand?

657. Kavi Karnapura, dear to the Lord, wrote a book
and told of the grace shown to Sanatana.

658. *Thus [it is said there]:*

"He who was the jewel ornament of the assembly of the lord of Gauda — the elder brother of Rupa — giving up flourishing wealth, took to wife the young Lakshmi of renunciation; within full of the rasa of bhakti, without in the guise of an avadhuta, like a great lake covered with moss, he gives joy to those who know him."

659. *[And again:]*

"As soon as He saw with His own eyes Sanatana arriving, the Lord, golden as a champaka, softened by boundless compassion, trembling, embraced him with His arms long as door-bolts."

660. *[And again:]*

"Seeing that in the course of time the accounts of the pastimes of Vrindavana had been lost, the Lord, in order to proclaim them especially, there and then sprinkled both Rupa and Sanatana with the nectar of His mercy."[58]

661. Seeing the Lord's mercy towards Sanatana,
the devotees who lived in Kashi rejoiced at heart.

662. At the Lord's command Sanatana went to Vraja,
while Rupa had left Vraja, and they did not meet.

663. The Lord, meanwhile, having returned to Nilachala, after some days
began to long for Rupa and Sanatana.

664. Sri Rupa with Vallabha, with joyful hearts,
hasten to Nilachala by way of Gauda.

665. Sri Rupa's younger brother, the wise Vallabha —
Sri Gaurasundara gave him the name Anupama.

666. He knows no one but Raghunatha
and is ever enraptured in the service of the Deity of Raghunatha.

667. "Chaitanya Gosani is Sri Raghunatha Himself" —
and he considers himself blessed to have found such a Lord.

668. What shall I say of the boundless greatness of Vallabha?
Sri Rupa came to Gauda with Vallabha.

669. Sri Vallabha passed [from this world] on the bank of the Ganga;
after some days Rupa came to Nilachala.

670. The bliss he felt on seeing in Nilachala
the Lord and His devotees — who can describe it?

671. The mercy shown to Rupa
by Sri Chaitanya, Advaita and Nitai with their associates cannot be told.

672. Having stayed for some time, at the Lord's command,
he set out for Vrindavana by way of Gauda.

673. The wealth that remained in Gauda he had brought
and distributed to his kin, to brahmanas and to temples.

674. Free of cares, he went to Vraja;
so it is written in the book Chaitanya-charitamrita.

675. From Vrindavana Sri Sanatana Gosvami
set out for Niladri by the road through Jharikhanda.

676. After some time he arrived in Nilachala;
seeing Sanatana, the Lord was overjoyed.

677. With what wondrous love He brought him together with all the devotees!
Having kept him for some time, He sent him back to Vraja.

678. In Vrindavana Sanatana met Sri Rupa;
this is described in detail in the Chaitanya-charitamrita.

679. He upon whom falls even a particle of the mercy of these two
develops love for the feet of Sri Krishna Chaitanya.

680. The son of a brahmana, the Gosvamis' family priest,
came to Vrindavana and received the mercy of both.

681. Giving up the desire for wealth he had had, with a joyful heart
he became a disciple of Sanatana Gosvami.

682. To this day his descendants in Madgram
know no one but Prabhu Sanatana.[59]

683. Sanatana and Rupa, softened by compassion,
revealed the lost tirthas in Mathura-mandala.

684. From Vrindavana [the Lord] drew Sri Jiva to Himself:
Sri Jiva Gosvami in Gauda grew restless.

685. How Sri Jiva Gosvami went to Vrindavana —
of this truly wondrous story I shall tell a little.

686. From the time the Gosvamis went to Vrindavana,
what came over Sri Jiva's heart!

687. Various jewelled ornaments, fine garments,
wondrous beds and luxurious meals —

688. all this he gave up, nothing pleases him,
and of kingdoms and worldly affairs he cannot bear to hear.

689. Seeing Sri Jiva's conduct, respectable people
speak to one another with affection:

690. "O brother! Among the sons of Kumara-deva
three are Vaishnavas and knowers of the shastras:

691. Sanatana, Sri Rupa and Vallabha — these three
gave up everything and became renunciants.

692. What wondrous renunciation — not a trace of attachment!
Such detachment is seen nowhere.

693. On the bank of the Ganga Vallabha passed to the next world,
and at a young age Sri Jiva suffered great grief.

694. Sri Jiva has no inclination for such wealth;
to tell how he fared breaks the heart.

695. One day I saw him in solitude:
he is ceaselessly drowned in the tears of both his eyes."

696. Another says: "O brother, that is true:
know for certain that Krishna's mercy rests on Sri Jiva.

697. In his youth his heart is very deep;
the Srimad Bhagavatam he regards as his second life.

698. He always swims in the ocean of happiness — talk of Krishna,
and no one dares out of fear to speak to him of anything else.

699. One day I watched unseen:
crying 'Sri Krishna Chaitanya!' he fell unconscious.

700. He rolls on the ground and cannot compose himself,
his face and chest are drenched by the streams from his eyes.

701. How he laments, weeping and weeping —
whose heart would not break at the sight of it?"

702. A third says: "O brother, this is what I think:
Sri Jiva will very soon leave home."

703. Someone says: "How will so tender a youth wander about?"
Another says: "Strong is his anuraga."

704. Someone says: "He is the lamp of the brahmana family;
if he goes, all will be plunged into darkness."

705. So all say many things with anxious hearts
and, unwilling to leave Sri Jiva, do not go home.

706. In Sri Jiva's mind there is ceaselessly one thought:
"When shall I leave home?"

707. One evening, sitting alone,
he chants the holy name and is bathed in tears.

708. However hard he tries, he cannot restrain himself;
raising both arms, he says again and again:

709. "O Prabhu Sri Krishna Chaitanya, Nityananda!
O ocean of mercy, Sri Advaitachandra!

710. O merciful dear associates of the Lord!
Make such a fallen one as me worthy of your mercy!"

711. So he speaks many times, his throat choking again and again;
the night passed, and there was no sleep in his eyes.

712. By the will of the Lord, who loves His devotees,
Sri Jiva, dozing a little, has a dream.

713. As he had seen in a dream in the village of Ramakeli,
so he sees Gaurachandra with His associates.

714. In the midst of the sankirtana Gaura-raya dances,
intoxicating the world with prema unattainable even for Brahma.

715. Hundreds of thousands of people come running from all sides;
the cry "Hari! Hari!" resounds on earth and in the sky.

716. Having appeared thus, the Lord vanished;
on waking, Jiva was thrown into turmoil.

717. Again sleep overcame Sri Jiva,
and Sri Jiva sees a wondrous dream.

718. I shall tell that dream, but first a little of the past:
truly wondrous is the life of Sri Jiva.

719. In his childhood Sri Jiva, with other boys,
knew no games but those connected with Sri Krishna.

720. Making figures of Krishna and Balarama,
he would worship Them with flowers, sandal and the like.

721. In various ornaments and garments They were very beautiful;
gazing at Them without blinking, he rejoiced at heart.

722. Falling to the ground like a golden doll,
he bowed to Them and was bathed in tears.

723. Offering Them various sweets with great care,
he would eat the prasada together with the boys.

724. Apart from Krishna and Balarama nothing pleases him;
even alone, in solitude, he plays with the two of Them.

725. Going to sleep, he keeps Them both on his chest,
and his father and mother cannot take Them away even in jest.

726. Seeing such great love for Krishna and Balarama,
seeing such conduct in a child, all rejoiced.

727. How Chaitanya and Nitai, from his childhood,
were subject to his love, They reveal in the dream:

728. Lord Krishna and Balarama appeared before him in person —
dark and white, both abodes of bliss.

729. The wondrous attire of the two enchants Kandarpa;
with the curves of Their bodies They intoxicate the three worlds.

730. Having seen Them thus, he sees Them again golden:
They shine, surpassing pure gold.

731. The fragrance of the bodies of both filled the three worlds,
and there is no one who can stay composed.

732. Sri Jiva was amazed at heart
and gazes unblinking at the beauty of the two.

733. Drowning in the tears of his long eyes,
he falls at the feet of the two Lords.

734. The oceans of mercy, Gaura and Nityananda-raya,
placed Their lotus feet on Jiva's head.

735. With great parental love They embrace him again
and speak nectarean words of comfort.

736. Sri Gaurasundara, overcome with great prema,
entrusted him to the feet of Prabhu Nityananda.

737. Nityananda says to Sri Jiva again and again:
"Let this Lord of Mine be everything to you."

738. Having received such mercy from the Lord, he bowed again —
and seeing that both had vanished, he cannot calm himself.

739. Waking, he sees that the night has passed;
on the pretext of study he set out for Navadvipa.

740. The people of Chandradvipa thought to themselves:
"Sri Jiva will certainly go to Vrindavana."[60]

741. Sri Jiva sent away the people accompanying him
and went from Fatehabad with one servant.

742. Overcome with prema, how wondrously he walks along the road!
Seeing Sri Jiva, people say to one another:

743. "Look, look, whose prince is this?
His body is captivating, the colour of a golden champaka.

744. How wondrous the beauty of his face — it steals the soul!
How lovely his long eyes and nose!

745. What brows, forehead, ears, what beautiful hair!
What cheeks and neck, what a wondrous chest!

746. How the lotuses of his hands and the rows of his nails shine!
What a slender waist, what shanks, knees and feet!

747. A wondrous tulasi-mala on his tender neck!
What a white, fine, beautiful sacred thread!

748. O brother, would that I could take all his troubles upon myself!
I long to gaze at him without cease, filling my eyes."

749. Someone says: "Brothers, looking at him
I do not know what is happening in my heart."

750. Someone says: "This is what I think:
he will certainly accept sannyasa."

751. So many speak with agitated hearts,
while Sri Jiva walks on, overcome with the highest prema.

752. As he entered Navadvipa the word spread:
"The nephew of Sanatana and Sri Rupa has come!"

753. Seeing Sri Jiva's conduct, the brahmanas and pandits —
whatever they asked him — were all amazed.

754. Sri Jiva entered Navadvipa
and, seeing the beauty of Navadvipa, was amazed.

755. Sixteen kroshas does beautiful Navadvipa extend;[61]
here and there are wells, flower gardens and ponds.

756. Seeing the banks of the celestial river, the groves and sandbanks —
is there anyone whose heart would not be gladdened?

757. Sri Jiva walks on in rapture,
and along the same road come several Vaishnavas.

758. Seeing Sri Jiva, they all, rejoicing at heart,
hastened to the house of Sri Srivasa Pandita.

759. There Prabhu Nityananda with His dear associates
sits enjoying the great bliss of prema.

760. The Lord, smiling, says to Srivasa Pandita:
"It seems to Me that Sri Jiva will come."

761. That Vaishnava says quietly to the Lord:
"Sri Jiva has come, Prabhu; he is outside the house."

762. Hearing this, Prabhu Nityananda was delighted
and quickly had people bring in Sri Jiva.

763. At the sight of the Lord Sri Jiva lost all composure
and cannot stem the streams of tears from both his eyes.

764. How he humbled himself cannot be put into words;
he falls at the feet of Prabhu Nityananda.

765. Prabhu Nityananda, overwhelmed with great parental love,
placed both His feet on Sri Jiva's head.

766. He showed Sri Jiva the utmost mercy:
raising him from the ground, He embraced him tightly.

767. In the rapture of prema the Lord says: "For your sake
I hastened here from Khardaha."

768. Saying many such things, He calmed Sri Jiva
and had Srivasa and the other devotees show him mercy.

769. Having kept him by His side in great joy,
He sends Sri Jiva off to the western country.

770. At parting [Jiva] was in great distress;
Sri Jiva bowed at the feet of Nityananda.

771. Placing His feet on Sri Jiva's head,
the Lord embraced him with great affection.

772. The Lord says: "Go quickly to Vraja:
the Lord has given that place to your family."[62]

773. With the Lord's permission Sri Jiva set out,
having honoured the feet of all the devotees.

774. What affection Srivasa Pandita and the other bhagavatas
showed Sri Jiva cannot be described.

775. From Navadvipa, his mind full of supreme bliss,
Sri Jiva Gosvami after some time reached Kashi.

776. There lives Sri Madhusudana Vachaspati,
a teacher of all the shastras, like Brihaspati.

777. Seeing Sri Jiva, he grew very fond of him
and, keeping him for some time, taught him Vedanta and the rest.

778. The joy Vachaspati felt
at seeing the power of Sri Jiva's learning I have no power to tell.

779. In Kashi everyone everywhere praises Sri Jiva:
"In nyaya, Vedanta and the other shastras there is no one like him."

780. From Kashi Sri Jiva went to Vrindavana,
and there Rupa and Sanatana showed him mercy.

781. Sanatana, Rupa and Sri Vallabha are three brothers;
to describe the lives of these three would have no end.

782. How Raghunatha Dasa came from Sri Purushottama
to Vrindavana I cannot relate.

783. Sanatana, Rupa and Raghunatha — these three...
Raghunatha's life and deeds are known to the world.

784. *Thus [it is said] in the Laghu-toshani:*
"The first is Srila Sanatana, his younger brother named Sri Rupa, then [the youngest] bearing the name Sriman Vallabha; turning away from royal power and obtaining the great mercy of Bhagavan Sri Krishna Chaitanya, they truly enjoyed the kingdom of the wealth of bhakti called prema for Murahara.

785. *He who was the youngest of all — my father — soon attained Sri Rama on the Ganga, while the elder [brothers] then came to Vrindavana; by them the hidden tirthas of Mathura were revealed, and bhakti for Sri Vrajaraja-nandana was raised high everywhere.*

786. *Their friend, known on earth as Raghunatha Dasa, ever shines, whirling in the waves of the great ocean of the prema of Radha and Krishna; surpassing the splendour of all examples, he is held by the best of the worthy in the three worlds, to their amazement, to be equal in nature to those two."*[63]

787. Sanatana and Rupa live in Vrindavana;
what is in the hearts of the two of them — who knows but Krishna?

788. To Sanatana and Rupa [the Lord] showed great mercy:
in the guise of a cowherd boy Gopala appeared before them.

789. He gave them wondrous condensed milk — what more is there to say?
There is no limit to the happiness of Sanatana and Rupa.

790. All that such Sanatana and Rupa, at the Lord's command,
wrote has spread throughout the world.

791. Sri Rupa composed the Sri Hamsa-duta and other books,
Sanatana wrote the Bhagavatamrita and others.

792. Having composed the Sri Vaishnava-toshani, Sanatana
ordered Sri Jiva to edit it.

793. Receiving the order, Jiva composed the Laghu-toshani
and wrote there how he had done it.

794. In [Shaka] 1476 the Brihat was completed,
in Shaka 1504 the Laghu.[64]

795. *Thus [it is said] in the same work:*
"In the guise of a cowherd boy Shriyuta Gopala Himself appeared to these two in the play of bringing them milk.

796. *Among the works of the younger of them are the poem Sri Hamsa-duta, the Srimad Uddhava-sandesha, and the Eighteen Metres;*

797. *the hymns Utkalika-vallari, Govinda-virudavali, Premendu-sagara and many others, firmly established;*

798. *the two dramas Vidagdha- and Lalita-madhava, the bhanika named Dana-keli, and the pair of Rasamritas;*

799. *the Mathura-mahima, the Padyavali, the Nataka-chandrika and the Abridged Sri Bhagavatamrita — these are compilations.*

800. *And among the works of the elder are the precious Srila Bhagavatamrita, the Hari-bhakti-vilasa and its commentary Dik-pradarshini,*

801. *the Lila-stava, and this commentary, the Vaishnava-toshani, which has been abridged by me, the insignificant Jiva, at his command.*

802. *Whatever I have written here hastily, unknowingly or knowingly, and whatever I have left out — may these [elders] forgive me both; and whatever has come forth from me — if that is all my strength, enough of misgivings.*[65]

803. *This auspicious commentary was completed in [Shaka] 1476, and abridged in 1504."*

804. So I have named the books of the Gosvamis;
now I shall tell of them in more detail — listen.

805. Sri Jiva's disciple Krishnadasa Adhikari
described this in detail in his book.[66]

806. Sanatana Gosvami has four books:
the Bhagavatamrita in two parts with a commentary,

807. the Hari-bhakti-vilasa with the commentary Dik-pradarshini,
the commentary on the Tenth Canto called the Vaishnava-toshani,

808. and the Lila-stava, which is called the Dashama-charita:
these are the four books of Sanatana Gosvami.

809. *Thus [it is said]:*
"The list of compilations of conclusions among the works of the elder of them, named Sri Sanatana, is this:

810. *first, the Bhagavatamrita in two parts, the Hari-bhakti-vilasa with its commentary Dik-pradarshini, the Lila-stava, and the commentary called the Vaishnava-toshani."*

811. Sri Rupa Gosvami wrote sixteen books,
revealing the utmost limit of both the pastimes and siddhanta:

812. the poems Hamsa-duta and Uddhava-sandesha,
the Krishna-janma-tithi-vidhi with all its injunctions,

813. the Ganoddesha-dipika in a larger and a smaller [recension],
the Stava-mala, the Vidagdha-madhava full of rasa,

814. the Lalita-madhava — the utmost limit [in depicting] separation,
the Dana-lila-kaumudi — an ocean of bliss,

815. known by the name Dana-keli-kaumudi,
the incomparable Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu,

816. the book Sri Ujjvala-nilamani, full of rasa,
the sweetest book Prayuktakhyata-chandrika,

817. the well-known Mathura-mahima and Padyavali,
the Nataka-chandrika and the Laghu-bhagavatamrita.

818. At the Vaishnavas' wish he composed eleven verses
and gave them to Krishnadasa Kaviraja to expand;[67]

819. in them are the pastimes of the eight periods of the day, a supreme elixir;
only the fortunate relish it.

820. Briefly he also composed the Viruda-lakshana,
but it is not counted among the books:

821. it is the definition [for] his Govinda-virudavali;
the two are one, hence it is known as the "Lakshana".

822. *Thus [it is said]:*
"Among the works of the younger of them are the poem Sri Hamsa-duta, the Srimad Uddhava-sandesha, the Injunctions on the Day of Krishna's Birth,

823. *the Sri Ganoddesha-dipika, known in a larger and a smaller [recension], the beautiful Stava-mala on Sri Krishna and His beloveds,*

824. *the famous Vidagdha-madhava and also the Lalita-madhava, the Dana-lila-kaumudi and also the Bhakti-rasamrita,*

825. *the [Ujjvala-]nilamani, the Prayuktakhyata-chandrika, the Mathura-mahima, the Padyavali, the Nataka-chandrika*

826. *and the Abridged Sri Bhagavatamrita — these are compilations. In the guise of a cowherd boy Gopala Himself, the son of Nanda, appeared to these two in the play of bringing them milk."*

827. These are the books of the middle Gosvami;
among them I shall tell of the Stava-mala.

828. The Gosvami composed his hymns one by one;
in Sri Jiva's collection they received the name Stava-mala.

829. *Thus [it is said in it]:*
"The Stava-mala, composed by the illustrious Ishvara Rupa, the author of the Rasamrita, has been collected by Jiva, who lives after him."[68]

830. Raghunatha Dasa Gosvami has three books:
the Stava-mala, which is called the Stavavali,

831. and the sweet Dana-charita and Mukta-charita,
on hearing which great sorrows go away.

832. *Thus [it is said]:*
"Among the works of the one named Raghunatha, who became the friend of those two, the Stava-mala and the Dana- and Mukta-charita are known."

833. Twenty-five books of Jiva are known:
the Hari-namamrita-vyakarana with its divine method,

834. the Sutra-malika, the well-composed Dhatu-sangraha,
the truly wondrous Krishnarcha-dipika,

835. the Gopala-virudavali, the Rasamrita-shesha,
the Sri Madhava-mahotsava, special in every respect,

836. the well-known book Sri Sankalpa-kalpa-vriksha,
the truly wondrous Bhavartha-suchaka-champu,

837. the commentaries on the Gopala-tapani, on the Brahma-samhita,
on the Rasamrita and on the Sri Ujjvala,

838. a coherent commentary on the Yoga-sara-stava,
an exposition of the Gayatri from the Agni Purana,

839. [a description of] the marks on Sri Krishna's feet according to the Padma Purana
and, separately, of the marks on Sri Radhika's hands and feet,

840. the Gopala-champu in two parts, the former and the latter —
what wondrous books he wrote, known to the world!

841. The seven famous Sandarbhas, after the manner of the Bhagavata:
the Tattva-, Bhagavat-, Paramatma-, Krishna-, Bhakti- and Priti-;

842. these six, and the seventh is the Krama-sandarbha;
in them sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana are revealed.

843. *Thus [it is said]:*
"Among the works of Sri Jiva, the son of Sriman Vallabha, are named: the grammar called Hari-namamrita,

844. *its Sutra-malika, the Dhatu-sangraha used in it, the subtle Krishnarcha-dipika, the Gopala-virudavali,*

845. *the Rasamrita-shesha, the Sri Madhava-mahotsava, the Sankalpa-kalpa-vriksha, the champu Bhavartha-suchaka,*

846. *the commentaries on the Gopala-tapani, on Brahma's Samhita, on the Rasamrita, on the Ujjvala and on the Yoga-sara-stava,*

847. *and also an exposition of the Gayatri in the Agni Purana, [a description] of the marks on Sri Krishna's feet named in the Padma,*

848. *and a collection of the marks on the hands and feet of Her who is a special form of Lakshmi — Sri Vrindavaneshvari;*

849. *the two champus, the former and the latter; and the seven famous Sandarbhas on the Srimad Bhagavatam,*

850. *named Tattva-, Bhagavat-, Paramatma-, Krishna-, Bhakti- and Priti-, and the seventh called Krama-;*

851. *in which the noble [authors] have revealed sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana — all three — like an amalaka fruit on the palm," and so on.*[69]

852. So I have told of the four Gosvamis;
much in the same way [earlier] devotees too have described them.

853. The essence of these books is understood only by one
to whom Sri Bhakti-devi has shown mercy.

854. The Vedas and Puranas sing the greatness of bhakti:
by the strength of bhakti nothing is impossible for a devotee.

855. The greatness of bhakti is praised by the Vedas and Puranas,
but the greatness of bhakti is known only to the devotees.

856. O friends, this one thing I beg:
may I always sing the greatness of bhakti and of the devotees!

857. May I never be touched
by the great unbelievers hostile to the devotees and to bhakti.

858. Glory to the devotees of Gaura, wish-fulfilling trees!
Be merciful: let my mind abide at the feet of Srinivasa.

859. Srinivasa Acharya Thakura is a jewel of virtues;
the earth considers itself blessed by his gift of bhakti.

860. In Gauda, Nilachala and Vrindavana Srinivasa
revealed what was in his heart.

861. If I am fortunate, this will be told in detail;
for now I shall tell briefly of his birth and the rest.

862. On the bank of the celestial river is the village of Chakhandi;
there he was born in the house of the brahmana Chaitanya.

863. There too the chudakarana and other rites were performed;
soon he studied grammar and the rest.

864. Hearing of the virtues of Sri Chaitanya-chandra, overcome with prema,
he joyfully sets out via Shrikhanda to the Kshetra,

865. with the desire in his heart to see in Nilachala
Sri Chaitanya-chandra and His associates.

866. While still on the way he heard that Sri Chaitanya had disappeared,
and became such that it seemed life would not stay in his body.

867. The Lord, who loves His devotees, the Lord of their lives,
at once appeared to him in the guise of a dream.

868. He comforted him, and he, receiving the Lord's command,
came to Nilachala and saw the Lord's dear associates.

869. There the Lord's associates showed him great mercy,
and at their command he came to Gauda.

870. His heart is constantly in turmoil and nothing can console him;
again he sets out for Nilachala from Shrikhanda.

871. Before reaching Jajpur he heard
that Gadadhara Pandita Gosvami had disappeared.

872. Unconscious, he falls to the ground and rolls on it,
and weeps so that stones melt to hear it.

873. In the guise of a dream Pandita Gosani comforted him,
and from there he went back to Gauda.

874. Like a madman he sits down wherever he happens to be
and tells no one anything of the anguish of his heart.

875. One day, walking along the road to Gauda,
he heard that Nityananda and Advaita had disappeared.

876. What became of him — who can tell?
He firmly resolved to give up his life.

877. In the guise of a dream both Lords appeared to him
and comforted him, lovingly speaking sweet words.

878. Rising in the morning, he set out for Gauda
and visited Navadvipa and all the other places.

879. By way of Shrikhanda he hastened to Vrindavana
and gave himself to the feet of Sri Gopala Bhatta.

880. There he met Narottama
and studied the books of the Gosvamis.

881. To bestow those jewels of books,
he came to Gauda at the command of all the Gosvamis.

882. In Vana-Vishnupura the king stole the books —
and, having returned the books, gave himself to his lotus feet.

883. Sri Sarakara Thakura arranged his marriage;[70]
after some time he went again to Vrindavana.

884. Again from Vrindavana he came to Gauda,
and his joy with Narottama increased without limit.

885. Prabhu Virachandra showed him great mercy,
and day and night he was absorbed in the rasa of sankirtana.

886. Everywhere he gave away the jewels of the books of bhakti,
and all the unbelievers and wretches were purified.

887. With all the disciples he accepted
he joyfully relished the rasa of bhakti.

888. In Gauda he revealed boundless bliss,
and after some time he went again to Vrindavana.

889. His journeys to Gauda and to Vrindavana —
by hearing of them desires are fulfilled.

890. I have told this briefly; it will be told more fully later;
be merciful, listeners, and accept it.

891. I am utterly ignorant and know nothing of the art of poetry;
as best I can, I glorify the lives of the devotees.

892. Leaving far behind the thieves who argue,
dive without cease into this Bhakti-ratnakara.

893. Meditating on the feet of Srinivasa Acharya,
Narahari Dasa tells the Bhakti-ratnakara.

Thus in the Sri Bhakti-ratnakara ends the first wave, called "A Brief Statement of the Birth of Srinivasa Acharya and Other Events", with the mangalacharana and accounts of various matters.

1. Verses 1–5 are Narahari's own Sanskrit mangalacharana; in the old editions (1888, 1912/13) only these are numbered, and the rest of the text runs on without numbers. The numbering of the whole taranga follows the Gaudiya Mission edition of 1960 (see the preface).

2. So in the editions of 1888 and 1912/13 ("shri-bhakti-ratna-pradanaika-daksha", "shachinandana-prema-rupa", "shrinivasa-dvijendra"); the 1960 edition reads differently: "best of devotees, uniquely skilled", "whose form is golden like the son of Shachi's", "Shri-nilaya" (= Srinivasa).

3. CC Adi 1.1.

4. Vasu is Vasudeva Ghosha and Madhava is Madhava Ghosha (the kirtan-singer brothers); Shankara is Shankara Pandita, the brother of Damodara Pandita.

5. The brahmana Haridasa is Haridasa Acharya (Dvija Haridasa), the father of Gokulananda and Shridasa (on them see further in this taranga). "The son of the Acharya" (acharya-nandana) is probably Achyutananda, the son of Advaita Acharya; the reading "the brahmana Haridasa, the son of the Acharya" is also possible.

6. Shashthidhara ("Yashtidhara" in the 1912/13 edition) is not identified. Vamshi is Vamshivadana; Saranga is Sarangadhara (Saranga Thakura); Sundara is probably Sundaranandа.

7. Kanu is Kanu Thakura (so in the editions of 1888 and 1912/13; the 1960 edition reads "Kanta").

8. The division of the Lord's pastimes into an Adi-, a Madhya- and a Shesha- (Antya-) khanda and their contents (43–44) follow the Chaitanya-bhagavata of Vrindavana Dasa.

9. "Balai loiya mari" — "to die taking another's misfortunes upon oneself": a common Bengali expression of tender love (cf. 65).

10. A couplet from the Chaitanya-bhagavata of Vrindavana Dasa (the old editions have "tathahi Chaitanya-bhagavate"); the chapter has not been verified.

11. The source of the verse is not stated. "Brahma-sutra" here may mean both the Vedanta-sutra (the truth it reveals) and the brahmana's sacred thread (upavita) with which the Lord is adorned in Navadvipa.

12. That is, discrepancies between the accounts of different authors are explained by the pastimes recurring in different kalpas with variations; this is a usual argument of Gaudiya Vaishnava authors (cf. CC, CB).

13. CC Madhya 9.82–83 (quoted with small variants).

14. In the CC (Adi 10) Gopala Bhatta is named among the Lord's branches without mention of his father; in Murari Gupta (3.15.15) he is the son of Trimalla Bhatta. Narahari follows the tradition that makes Venkata his father.

15. The source of the verse is not given ("said by the ancients").

16. Gopala's vision: the Lord appears to him first as Shyama-Krishna in cowherd dress, then golden (as Gaura) in the same cowherd attire (114–118), and finally in the form of a sannyasi (119).

17. "Trikachchha" — a dhoti tucked in three places, as cowherds wear it.

18. "Your disciple" is Srinivasa Acharya, the disciple of Gopala Bhatta who brought the books of the Gosvamis to Gauda (on him see further).

19. Hari-bhakti-vilasa 1.2.

20. Gadadhara Pandita served the Deity of Tota-Gopinatha in Puri; "Mishra's house" is the house of Kashi Mishra, where the Lord lived.

21. The reading is unclear: the 1912/13 edition has "matta paiya" ("in rapture"?), the 1960 edition "yatna paiya" ("with care"?). From 193 it is clear that the letter was sent with a messenger.

22. An allusion to Srinivasa Acharya, who will bring the books of the Gosvamis to Gauda.

23. The Lord's cord (dor), kaupina and outer cloth (bahirvas). In the Prema-vilasa (vilasa 1) the Lord sends Gopala Bhatta His waist-cord and seat.

24. Cf. CC Madhya 1, where the Hari-bhakti-vilasa is named as a work of Sanatana. Narahari reconciles both traditions: Sanatana composed it in the name of Gopala Bhatta.

25. According to a widespread tradition, Radha-ramana manifested from Gopala Bhatta's shalagrama; here Narahari only says briefly that Rupa entrusted him with the service, and promises to tell more later.

26. Cf. CB: Vrindavana Dasa repeatedly says that details of the Lord's pastimes "Vedavyasa will describe in the Puranas"; here Narahari calls Vrindavana Dasa himself an incarnation of Vyasa.

27. On the prohibition by Gopala Bhatta and Lokanatha Gosvami against Krishnadasa Kaviraja writing about them, cf. the Prema-vilasa and the Narottama-vilasa.

28. Govardhana is apparently the landholder Govardhana Majumdar, the father of Raghunatha Dasa Gosvami, famed for his generosity. The drama Sangita-madhava is attributed to Govinda Kaviraja (Govindadasa), Ramachandra's brother.

29. The text has "vipra-vara" ("best of brahmanas"), although Damodara Sena's family were vaidyas (see 262); the word seems to be used in the general sense of "worthy man".

30. CC Madhya 11.92.

31. Kaviraja means "king of poets" (and is at the same time the usual title of vaidya physicians).

32. The name of the town in the verse is corrupt (the editions read "sarajani-nagare"); "chief minister of the king of Gauda" interprets the unclear "gauda-bhupadhipatra". "The illustrious one" renders "shriman-nara-khya" ("the one called Nara"), i.e. Narottama.

33. From the mangalacharana of the Hari-bhakti-vilasa (first vilasa). The Vaishnava-toshani (322–323) is Sanatana Gosvami's commentary on the tenth canto of the Bhagavata; the verse is from its introduction.

34. The custom of giving an "unattractive" name to a child born after the death of older children, to ward off misfortune.

35. The two brothers are Gaura and Nityananda, who according to tradition dwell in the Deities of Gauridasa Pandita at Ambika (Kalna).

36. Subala is Gauridasa Pandita (according to the GGD, the cowherd boy Subala, Krishna's friend); Shyamananda is the disciple of his disciple Hridaya Chaitanya (Hridayananda). The Shyamananda-shataka is a work on Shyamananda (author not named).

37. The Deities of Gaura and Nityananda at Ambika (Kalna), served by Gauridasa Pandita and Hridaya Chaitanya.

38. A song from Narottama Dasa's Prarthana ("Gaurangera duti pada").

39. Cf. the Prema-vilasa and the Narottama-vilasa: the name Shyamananda was given by Jiva Gosvami after Duhkhi Krishnadasa found Radha's nupura; here it is only mentioned briefly (in detail in the sixth taranga).

40. Sri Murari is Rasikananda (Rasika Murari), Shyamananda's chief disciple in Orissa.

41. The six Deities of Kheturi established by Narottama: Gauranga, Vallavikanta, Sri Krishna, Vrajamohana, Radha-ramana and Radha-kanta (with Their Radhas).

42. A song by Govindadasa (Govinda Kaviraja) in Brajabuli. The signature at the end ("only Govindadasa is left deprived") is the poet's usual humble word about himself in padas.

43. A song by Govindadasa about Rama (in Brajabuli), composed for King Harinarayana, a worshipper of Rama. "Bharata's younger brother" is Shatrughna; "the son of the Wind" is Hanuman.

44. A prose extract from the prologue of the Sangita-madhava. Grammatically the agent here is Santosha ("by him composed... and presented"); according to 461 the drama was composed by Govinda Kaviraja with Santosha's permission, so "composed by him" is understood as "at his wish".

45. The Deities of Kheturi are listed (cf. 426). At the end there is a pun: "santosha" means "joy, satisfaction". The text of the verse is corrupt in the editions; the translation is approximate.

46. The second half of the couplet is restored from the 1888 edition; in the editions of 1912/13 and 1960 the line is corrupt.

47. This verse (from a tantra) is also quoted in Rupa Gosvami's Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu (1.1.36).

48. Bhag. 5.6.18.

49. The Laghu-toshani is Jiva Gosvami's abridgement of Sanatana's Vaishnava-toshani (a commentary on the tenth canto of the Bhagavata). Verses 537–539 and further 569–577 (the genealogy) are from it.

50. Naihati lies on the eastern bank of the Ganga (Bhagirathi), north of Calcutta.

51. Bakla-Chandradvipa is a region in the present Barisal district (East Bengal); Fatehabad is in the land of Yashohara (Jessore).

52. Danujamardana is apparently a king of Chandradvipa (Bakla).

53. Vidya-vachaspati is the brother of Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya; Vidya-bhushana, Paramananda Bhattacharya, Ramabhadra and Vani-vilasa are teachers of Sanatana named in the introduction to his commentary on the tenth canto (the Vaishnava-toshani). The plural "gurus" in the verse may also refer to Vachaspati alone (plural of respect).

54. Cf. CC Madhya 1 (the meeting at Ramakeli).

55. Cf. CC Antya 4: the Lord showed the world the sense-control of Ramananda, the impartiality of Damodara, the forbearance of Haridasa and the humility of Sanatana and Rupa.

56. That the young Jiva saw the Lord at Ramakeli is a tradition Narahari relates on the word of "very old people"; cf. CC.

57. CC Madhya 19–20.

58. Verses 658–659 are Kavi Karnapura's Chaitanya-chandrodaya 9.34–35 (../chaitanya-chandrodaya/en/09.md); 660 is apparently from the same work.

59. Madgram (Margram) is a village; the descendants of this brahmana, a disciple of Sanatana, lived there in the author's time.

60. So in the 1912/13 edition ("Chandradvipa"); the 1960 edition has "the people of Navadvipa".

61. So in the 1960 edition; the 1912/13 edition has "eight kroshas". A krosha is a measure of length of about 3–3.5 km.

62. The account of Jiva's meeting with Nityananda in Srivasa's house and of Jiva's later circuit of Navadvipa with Nityananda is developed in the twelfth taranga.

63. Verses 784–786 and 795–803 are from the conclusion of Jiva Gosvami's Laghu-toshani (the continuation of the genealogy given in 569–577). "Attained Sri Rama on the Ganga": Vallabha (Anupama), a worshipper of Rama, left his body on the bank of the Ganga (cf. 669).

64. That is, Sanatana's Brihad-vaishnava-toshani was completed in 1554 and Jiva's Laghu-toshani in 1582 CE (cf. 803).

65. The text of the verse is corrupt in the editions; the translation is approximate.

66. Krishnadasa Adhikari is a disciple of Jiva Gosvami; his book is not named here.

67. Rupa's eleven verses on the pastimes of the eight periods of the day (the Smarana-mangala); Krishnadasa Kaviraja expanded them in his poem Govinda-lilamrita.

68. The concluding verse of the Stava-mala as collected by Jiva Gosvami. "The middle Gosvami" (827) is Rupa, the middle of the three brothers.

69. Verses 843–851 continue the same list (from the conclusion of the Laghu-toshani). "The two champus" are the two parts of the Gopala-champu; "Brahma's Samhita" is the Brahma-samhita.

70. Cf. the Prema-vilasa on Srinivasa's marriage. It is told in detail in the thirteenth taranga.

Taranga 2. An Account of the Birth of Srinivasa and Other Matters; the Appearance of Sri Govinda and the Other Deities in Vrindavana

Glory to the Lord and His associates; the brahmana Gangadhara witnesses the Lord's sannyasa at Katwa and becomes Chaitanya Dasa; the birth, childhood and studies of Srinivasa; the meeting with Narahari Sarakara; Rupa and Sanatana in Vraja; the appearance of Govinda, Madanamohana and Gopinatha

1. Glory, glory to Gaura-Krishna, the enchanter of the worlds,
the Lord of Nadia, the life of His devotees!

2. Glory, glory to Nityananda-deva, Haladhara!
Glory, glory to Sri Advaita Acharya, the Lord!

3. Glory, glory to Gadadhara Pandita and Srivasa!
Glory to Sri Svarupa, Vakreshvara and Haridasa!

4. Glory to Vasudeva Sarvabhauma, [like] Brihaspati!
Glory to Raya Ramananda, the embodiment of rasa!

5. Glory to the great-hearted Pundarika Vidyanidhi!
Glory to the noble Sri Jagadananda Pandita!

6. Glory to Vidya-vachaspati, renowned in the world!
Glory, glory to the generous Shrinatha Chakravarti!

7. Glory to Gadadhara Dasa and Narahari Dasa!
Glory to Sri Mukunda, worthy of prema-bhakti!

8. Glory to Vasu Ghosha, Gauridasa and Dhananjaya!
Glory to Vanamali and Sri Garuda Mahashaya!

9. Glory, glory to Vallabha Acharya and Sanatana!
Glory to the brahmana Haridasa and to the son of the Acharya!

10. Glory, glory to the merciful Rupa and Sanatana!
Glory to Sri Gopala Bhatta, the abode of prema!

11. Glory to Raghunatha Bhatta and Raghunatha Dasa!
Glory to Sri Jiva, whose pastimes are wondrous!

12. Glory to Sri Bhugarbha, Lokanatha and Shashthidhara!
Glory to Sri Subuddhi Mishra and Sri Chandrashekhara!

13. Glory to Kashi Mishra, Gopikanta and Bhagavan!
Glory to the lotus-eyed Hridayananda!

14. Glory to Jagannatha Sena and Sri Madhusudana!
Glory to Chiranjiva Sena and Sri Raghunandana!

15. Glory to Sri Saranga and Abhirama, jewel of virtues!
Glory to Sri Thakura Vrindavana, the treasury of prema!

16. Glory to Krishnadasa Kaviraja Mahashaya!
Glory to Sri Acharya Srinivasa, full of prema!

17. Glory to Sri Thakura Mahashaya Narottama!
Glory to Shyamananda, the charming embodiment of bhakti!

18. Glory, glory to the devotees of Sri Gaurachandra:
all of them give prema-bhakti and purify the fallen!

19. Countless are Chaitanya's devotees, boundless their deeds;
Sri Krishna Chaitanya-chandra is everything to them.

20. Glory, glory to the listeners, abodes of virtue!
Now listen with kind hearts to what I shall tell.

21. On the bank of the Bhagirathi is the village of Sri Chakhandi;
there lives a brahmana named Sri Chaitanya Dasa.

22. Formerly he was called Gangadhara Bhattacharya;
listen to how he received this name.

23. The moon of Navadvipa, Gaura, the ocean of virtues,
was playing ceaselessly in Nadia with His associates.

24. Having somehow made known to all what was in His heart,
He came to Kantaka-nagara, where Sri Bharati was.[1]

25. "Gaura-raya will accept sannyasa!" —
the word spread everywhere, and hearing it people come running.

26. Children, youths, old people, men and women —
all were enchanted on seeing Gaura.

27. Gazing at His beautiful curling hair,
all stand like painted dolls.

28. How fearful men and women were at heart —
who can tell it with one mouth?

29. The all-knowing Gaurachandra says to everyone:
"Give Me your blessing that I may have bhakti for Krishna."

30. Having said this, the Lord stays with Bharati
and says to Bharati: "There is no need for delay."

31. Bharati is distraught and cannot say anything;
at the Lord's command the barber came.

32. Not daring to disobey, he bowed at His feet,
placed his hand on the Lord's head — and burst into tears.

33. By the Lord's will he shaved off His hair
and rolls on the ground: "What have I done, what have I done!"

34. Seeing that the Lord's head was bare of hair,
the people all around weep.

35. The earth was soaked with the tears of countless people;
in the uproar of weeping no one hears anything.

36. Neither men nor women can restrain themselves:
they beat their heads and revile the Creator.

37. Gangadhara Bhattacharya was there;
seeing the Lord's sannyasa, he weeps aloud.

38. The brahmana was bathed in the tears of both his eyes
and fell unconscious to the ground.

39. Only by the Lord's will did he remain alive,
and after some time he partly came to his senses.

40. The Lord received the name Sri Krishna Chaitanya,
and the name "Sri Chaitanya" entered the brahmana's ears.

41. The brahmana repeats the name of Sri Chaitanya again and again,
and tears flow from his eyes without cease.

42. He cannot stay in Kantaka-nagara
and, like a madman, walks along the bank of the Ganga.

43. He calls out constantly, "Chaitanya! Chaitanya!" —
and neither bathing nor eating nor anything else appeals to him.

44. In this way he came to the village of Chakhandi;
seeing Gangadhara, everyone was amazed.

45. Watching Gangadhara Bhattacharya from a distance,
a most sattvic brahmana

46. says to another: "What a wonder is this?
Gangadhara Bhattacharya has lost his mind!"

47. The other says: "Why he has lost his mind
I know something of — listen attentively.

48. In Nadia there is Nimai Pandita, a portion of God,
supremely beautiful, radiant as the sun.

49. His power is known to the whole world;
leaving home, he came to Kantaka-nagara.

50. His wondrous attire, enchanting Kandarpa,
he gave up and accepted sannyasa.

51. Sri Keshava Bharati gave him sannyasa
and named the pandita Sri Krishna Chaitanya.

52. Seeing the sannyasa, no one could restrain himself:
all around people wept in distress.

53. Standing on the path of the sky the gods wept:
rain fell without clouds — so people judged then.

54. When the hair disappeared, Gangadhara lost all composure
and, crying 'Ha, Chaitanya!', at that very moment went mad.

55. He has given up all activities, his eyes stream ceaselessly;
I see no way for him to be well."

56. Someone says: "He is Chaitanya's servant;
Chaitanya will make him well, so I think."

57. Saying such things, many [people] call the brahmana Gangadhara
"Sri Chaitanya Dasa" again and again.

58. Hearing himself called "Sri Chaitanya Dasa",
he responds, and his heart rejoices without cease.

59. No one any longer uses Gangadhara's former name:
everyone calls him "Sri Chaitanya Dasa".

60. Thus he received the name "Sri Chaitanya Dasa";
after some time, recovering himself, he settled in the village.

61. From a very old brahmana of the village of Chakhandi
I heard all this.

62. Extraordinary is the bhakti of Chaitanya Dasa,
and so too is his chaste wife Lakshmipriya.

63. They were childless, yet they had no desires at all;
by the Lord's will the desire for a son arose.

64. The brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa says to his wife:
"Why has the desire for a son suddenly arisen?

65. My heart is troubled on account of a son;
think it over and tell me how I may find peace."

66. Lakshmipriya says: "Let us go quickly to Nilachala:
by the darshan of the Lord everything will be fulfilled."[2]

67. Hearing this, Chaitanya Dasa rejoiced at heart,
and the two of them set out in haste by way of Yajigrama.

68. In Yajigrama lives the brahmana Balarama,
the father of Sri Lakshmipriya, very pure in conduct.

69. They stayed there two or four days
and set out at a most auspicious moment.

70. The brahmana saw his daughter and son-in-law off
and humbly asked them to bow at the Lord's feet for him.

71. The brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa, beside himself with joy,
sees the most auspicious omens at the time of parting.

72. Many people come and go to Nilachala;
the two of them set out — a fine company of fellow travellers came together.

73. One night husband and wife
lament bitterly and weep:

74. "We have wasted such a human birth,
we never once remembered the Lord's lotus feet!

75. Will we have the good fortune to see our fill
of the sweetness of Sri Krishna Chaitanya and Jagannatha?"

76. Having said many such things, the brahmana lay down to sleep,
and in his sleep he sees a wondrous dream:

77. youthful, in the form of beautiful Shyama,
in the threefold-bending pose — the king of millions of Kandarpas;

78. a peacock feather on His head, clad in yellow garments,
the beauty of His face surpassing millions of moons;

79. His body adorned with ornaments, anointed with sandal,
He plays the flute, enchanting the whole world.

80. Having seen Him thus, he sees Him again golden:
He shines, surpassing pure gold,

81. wearing cloth the colour of a cloud with a red border,
and all else as before — a treasury of rasa.

82. And again he sees the golden form in another attire:
with staff and water-pot, His head shaven.

83. And again he sees Him in a captivating dark form,
with most beautiful eyes like lotus petals,

84. together with Balabhadra and Subhadra;
Brahma and others with joyful hearts offer praise.[3]

85. So the best of brahmanas sees many mysteries;
suddenly waking, he is in turmoil.

86. Lakshmipriya comforted him in every way,
and in the morning the brahmana went on with joy at heart.

87. After some time they arrived in Nilachala,
their hearts longing to see the Lord.

88. The all-knowing Lord, by that very road at the Lion Gate,
comes with His dear associates.

89. What a wondrous gait, surpassing the step of the king of elephants!
The earth considers itself blessed by the touch of His feet.

90. His golden body surpasses a mountain of gold,
His radiance surpasses the morning sun.

91. How many moons rise in His face!
From His sweet smile nectar ever rains down.

92. The gleam of His teeth steals Kandarpa's pride;
who can stay composed seeing the beauty of His nose?

93. His two lotus eyes reach to His ears,
on His forehead a sandal tilaka sparkles.

94. At His neck is a tulasi garland that enchants the worlds;
seeing His broad chest, Kama faints.

95. He wears a captivating cloth the colour of dawn,
His arms reach to His knees, surpassing an elephant's trunk.

96. Wondrous is the beauty of His waist with its three folds;
at the lotus of His navel a line of hair winds like bees.

97. His slender waist steals the lion's pride,
His thighs are sweet, surpassing banana stems.

98. His beautiful feet, cherished by Lakshmi,
light up the earth with the radiance of their nails.

99. At such a Gaurachandra the brahmana and his wife,
standing to one side, gaze without blinking.

100. On whatever limb the glance falls, there it stays;
tears of joy flow from their eyes without cease.

101. What became of them on seeing that head without hair —
who can tell?

102. Prabhu Sri Krishna Chaitanya, glancing from the corner of His eye,
rained the nectar of mercy on the fortunate brahmana.

103. In sweet words He speaks to the brahmana, comforting him:
"Jagannatha has gladly brought you here.

104. Go, go, have the darshan of Jagannatha:
Sri Padmalochana will fulfil your desire."

105. Hearing the words from the moon-like mouth,
the best of brahmanas fell to the ground and bowed again and again.

106. Body, mind and life he gave to the Lord's feet,
and the all-knowing Lord accepted the brahmana as His own.

107. The Lord says to Govinda: "This brahmana is simple-hearted:
arrange for him the darshan of Jagannatha without hindrance."

108. Having said this, Gaurachandra with His devotees
set out for the darshan of Nilachala-chandra.

109. Sri Chaitanya Dasa bowed to the Lord's associates;
how humbly he behaved cannot be told.

110. Seeing Chaitanya Dasa's conduct, all
treated him as was fitting, and he became close to all.

111. At the Lord's command, together with the Lord's associates,
the brahmana went for the darshan of Jagannatha.

112. Seeing both in one place — the moving and the unmoving Brahman —
the brahmana felt joy without end.

113. He offered many prayers in secret;
smiling, Gaurahari looks at the brahmana.

114. He entrusted the brahmana to Jagannatha's feet
and by a hint told him to go to Gauda.

115. Having seen Jagannatha, the Lord with His devotees
came to the house of His dear Kashi Mishra.

116. Sri Chaitanya Dasa, having received the Lord's command,
went to his lodging in great joy.

117. The devotees went to their own lodgings,
talking to one another about the brahmana.

118. The next day they all said to Govinda:
"We cannot understand what this brahmana prayed for."

119. Govinda says: "There is a mystery in this;
by the Lord's will it will surely be revealed."

120. At that very time the Lord called Govinda
and, absorbed in bhava, speaks in a deep voice:

121. "This brahmana came desiring a son;
a son named Srinivasa will be born to him.

122. Through Sri Rupa and others I shall reveal the shastras of bhakti,
and through Srinivasa I shall distribute the jewels of the books.

123. Srinivasa is the embodiment of My pure prema;
seeing him, all will rejoice at heart.

124. Let the brahmana go quickly to Gauda."
Having said many such things, He restrained His bhava.

125. Meanwhile, in a dream there came Jagannatha's command:
"Do not delay, brahmana, go to Gauda.

126. A son full of prema will be born to you;
in a short time he will be victorious in all the shastras."

127. Having seen such a dream, the brahmana thinks to himself:
"How can I leave this happiness and go?

128. The son of the king of Vraja, Gaurachandra, Jagannatha,
has accepted such a wretch as me as His own."

129. Speaking of the Lord's beautiful and auspicious life,
the brahmana and his wife weep in rapture.

130. At that time Govinda came there
and carefully brought the brahmana to the Lord.

131. The Lord, sending His servant with His dear brahmana,
had him shown Nilachala-chandra and brought back.

132. Smiling, He says: "Jagannatha is pleased with you;
soon your desire will be fulfilled.

133. Go quickly to Gauda
and perform the sankirtana of the holy name without cease."

134. Having said this, the Lord sent the brahmana off;
the brahmana departs, humbly bowing at the Lord's feet.

135. How the Lord and His servant were at the parting
I have no power to describe.

136. He bowed at the feet of the Lord's associates
and with humility and meekness took his leave.

137. When the brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa took his leave,
the hearts of the devotees were troubled.

138. The brahmana with his wife set out in haste,
having bowed to Patita-pavana at the Lion Gate.[4]

139. Weeping and weeping, the brahmana walks along the road;
whoever sees him finds his eyes gladdened.

140. At the Lord's command the brahmana came to Gauda;
all this became known in every land.

141. With joy at heart he arrived in Yajigrama
and told everything to Balarama Sharma.

142. Having stayed there two or four days,
he came with Balarama to his own home.

143. Hearing of his return, his friends in the village
came to meet the brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa.

144. Having stayed five or seven days, Balarama
returned with joy at heart to Yajigrama.

145. There is no limit to the good fortune of the village of Sri Chakhandi,
where the brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa lives.

146. What unrestrained prema Sri Chaitanya Dasa has!
He is always enraptured with the rasa of talk of Krishna.

147. Having given his mind to the feet of Sri Gaurachandra,
in solitude he performs nama-sankirtana daily.

148. Seeing the wondrous way of bhakti of Sri Chaitanya Dasa,
some of the villagers are pleased,

149. and some say: "All this is useless —
that is why he is poor and childless."

150. Hearing such words, the brahmana's wife and the brahmana
answer no one, but only smile to themselves.

151. To dispel the evil thoughts of those people,
after some time Lakshmipriya conceived.

152. From the time the auspicious conception took place,
even the evil people began to honour her.

153. The women long to see Lakshmipriya:
seeing her, they are filled with love and cannot leave.

154. From who knows where various gifts are brought;
the child she carries draws all hearts.

155. The time of the birth arrived;
the brahmana and his friends rejoice at heart.

156. On the full-moon day of Vaishakha, under the nakshatra Rohini,
at an auspicious moment Lakshmipriya gave birth to a son.[5]

157. What auspicious signs there were at Srinivasa's birth
I cannot describe because of the bulk of the book.

158. The brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa, when his son was born,
saw various mysteries in a dream.

159. Wondrous is the son's beauty, all auspicious marks are on him,
the radiance of his body is like a golden champaka.

160. In great joy the brahmana and his wife together
offered their son to the feet of Gaurachandra.

161. Hearing of the son's birth, all their kin
came to the house of Sri Chaitanya Dasa.

162. Blessing the son with joy at heart,
they spoke many most sweet words.

163. The women, looking at the boy, gladden their eyes;
all wish him well, [showering him] with rice grains and durva grass.

164. They praise the good fortune of Sri Chaitanya Dasa,
and no one can go off to his own home.

165. Day by day the son grows like the moon;
all the fortunate gaze at him, filling their eyes.

166. After some time the brahmana in great joy
gave his son his first rice on a splendid day.

167. How the name-giving had been performed before
I have not described for fear of length.

168. Everyone says: "His name is Srinivasa";
they do not know that this name was proclaimed beforehand.

169. So all joyfully say many things,
and Srinivasa draws all hearts.

170. After some time he crawls about the courtyard;
seeing his antics, everyone rejoices.

171. Holding his mother's finger, he walks on his little feet,
stumbling and looking all around.

172. Letting go of his mother's finger, he falls on the ground,
and his mother, laughing, quickly takes him in her arms.

173. Other brahmanas' wives, speaking affectionate words,
take him in their arms and kiss his lovely face.

174. So, passing Srinivasa from arm to arm,
what joy they feel cannot be told.

175. One day Lakshmipriya, joyful at heart,
says to Srinivasa in the sweetest words:

176. "Come, my son, say: 'Gaura Vishvambhara,
husband of Lakshmi and Vishnupriya, son of Shachi,

177. Lord of Gadadhara's life, Master of Srivasa,
Sri Krishna Chaitanya, Nityananda-Haladhara.'

178. Come, say: 'Sri Advaita Prabhu, the merciful.'
Come, say: 'Radha-Krishna, son of Sri Nanda,

179. Govinda, Gopinatha, Madanamohana'" —
so she says the names of the Lord and His associates.

180. Hearing this, Srinivasa in great joy
pronounces some and cannot pronounce others.

181. Hearing those nectarean words, their ears gladdened,
they raise their son in supreme joy.

182. Srinivasa reached five years of age;
he wants to study — hearing this, all are glad.

183. After some time they had his schooling begun:
study was in name only, everything revealed itself to him without effort.

184. After some time the chudakarana was performed,
and the sacred thread shone wondrously on his shoulder.

185. In a short time he studied grammar, lexicons, poetics,
logic and the rest — people were amazed.

186. The fortunate Dhananjaya Vidya-vachaspati
passed on knowledge to him as best he could.

187. In Chakhandi live many learned men,
and all of them grow shy on seeing Srinivasa.

188. The old venerable brahmanas devoted to Vishnu
say to one another: "What a wonder!

189. In a short time he has mastered all the shastras;
he is always spotlessly pure and careful on the path of bhakti.

190. We have lived here a long time,
but we have never seen such a boy.

191. What a body — the colour of pure gold!
How beautiful his face, how sweet his speech!

192. When he laughs nectar falls, his teeth are lovely;
how captivating are his two long eyes!

193. What a nose, what ears, cheeks, brows and forehead!
What glossy, curling, beautiful hair!

194. What a curve of the arms, what a handsome broad chest!
Incomparable is the charm of his waist, his middle is slender.

195. What knees, shanks and tender feet!
Can a human being, unless he is a portion of a god, be like this?

196. Sri Chaitanya Dasa was childless —
and the Lord gave him a son, the embodiment of bliss."

197. Someone says: "Would that I could take his troubles upon myself!
When I do not see him I know not what happens to my heart — I cannot forget him."

198. Someone says: "In worldly life we suffer great sorrow,
but when you see him happiness arises in the mind."

199. Someone says: "I have many sons and daughters,
but my love for Srinivasa is greater than for them.

200. On what pretext could I tell Sri Chaitanya Dasa
to get him married soon?"

201. So, speaking with one another, they bless him;
in their hearts is one desire — always to see their fill of him.

202. How Srinivasa was born in Chakhandi and what he is like —
all this became known everywhere.

203. To the houses of the devotees who live near Chakhandi
Srinivasa constantly goes.

204. Sri Govinda Ghosha and others, losing all composure out of love,
bathe him in the nectar of Sri Gaurachandra's pastimes.

205. How can I tell what joy they all feel?
He keeps in his heart the wish of each.

206. Moment by moment how wondrously [their] love shows itself!
All say: "Srinivasa is the embodiment of prema for Gaura."

207. Everyone everywhere talks of Srinivasa,
everyone longs to see Srinivasa.

208. Sri Narahari and Sri Raghunandana of Shrikhanda
long without cease to see Srinivasa.

209. Srinivasa always yearns to see them,
but he cannot go alone.

210. Unexpectedly someone came from Yajigrama,
and Srinivasa went with him to Yajigrama.

211. Sri Narahari Thakura with his people
was going to bathe in the Ganga by way of Yajigrama.

212. The joy he felt on seeing Srinivasa there —
who can describe it with one mouth?

213. Srinivasa, seeing Sri Sarakara Thakura,
lost all composure; his heart overflowed with happiness.

214. When he, most humble, was about to bow,
the Thakura, overwhelmed with love, embraced him.

215. He speaks sweet words to Srinivasa:
"Seeing you, my eyes and heart are gladdened.

216. I very much wanted to see you, my son."
Saying this, he strokes his body with his lotus hands.

217. Srinivasa, with joined palms, pleads:
"Act so that my desire may be fulfilled.

218. I am utterly ignorant and do not even know how to speak;
protect me yourself in every way."

219. He says many such things, his tears flowing without cease;
the Thakura comforted him and bade him: "Go home."

220. Astonishing is the greatness of Sri Sarakara Thakura:
in Vraja he is Madhumati, whose virtues have no limit.

221. *Thus [it is said] in the Sri Gaura-ganoddesha:*
"Madhumati, formerly a dear friend in Vrindavana, is now the Sarakara named Narahari, dear to the Lord."[6]

222. *Thus [it is said] in a verse of Sriman Rupa:*
"She who formerly dwelt in Vrindavana, full of rasa, whose nature is the rasa of delight in the play of Radha and Ghanashyama — Madhumati, a follower of the perfect ones — she, Sri Sarakara Thakkura, who here gives prema to those who long for prema, a great ocean of the bliss of prema, is victorious in the land of Sri Khanda."

223. *Thus [it is said] in a verse of Sri Karnapura:*
"I bow to a certain great giver of prema bearing the name Sri Madhumati — a worthy vessel of the honey of the great mercy of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, joyfully blossoming in speech swallowed by streams of dense prema, who made his dwelling in Sri Khanda and is ever anointed with sandal."[7]

224. So the wise describe much of his life;
but how he loved Srinivasa cannot be described.

225. The joy [Srinivasa] felt on drinking the nectar of Sri Sarakara Thakura's command —
who could describe it?

226. Srinivasa returned quickly to the village of Chakhandi
and listens without cease to the pastimes of Gaurachandra.

227. One day, rejoicing, he asks his father
about the beautiful life of Gauranga.

228. The brahmana says: "He whose end Brahma and the others do not find —
how shall I, a wretched soul, tell of His pastimes?

229. Listen, listen, Srinivasa, I shall tell you:
Vishvambhara-raya is Krishna, the Moon of Vrindavana.

230. When in Navadvipa He played as a child,
at that time we were students.

231. Not understanding the essence of bhakti, we studied logic and the rest
and always kept company with those turned away [from God].

232. Day by day hearing of the wondrous pastimes of the Lord,
I kept thinking: I shall go and see.

233. But because of bad company I could not go there,
nor could I bear their arrogance.

234. Intoxicated with learning, they think nothing of anyone;
at any mention of the Lord they all laugh.

235. I suffer greatly in my heart and cannot master myself;
I pray to the Creator without cease:

236. 'Crush their pride quickly!'
Listen how the Creator fulfilled [my prayer].

237. Suddenly a digvijayi came to Navadvipa;
before his might everyone trembled.

238. The goddess Sarasvati is subject to his devotion;
therefore he is a great poet and expert in the shastras.

239. There is no one who could defeat him;
all the teachers gather together in anxiety.

240. The scholars of Chakhandi and elsewhere,
hearing of this, find no peace.

241. At that time Narayana, the Husband of Sarasvati,
named Nimai Pandita, was teaching grammar.

242. A teacher of grammar, with many students
He played in great merriment on the bank of Sri Jahnavi.

243. The digvijayi, seeing the wondrous youth,
approached, laughing in the pride of his learning.

244. When he drew near, the Lord, showing him honour,
asked him to describe the greatness of the Ganga.

245. In a moment he composed many verses,
truly wondrous and flawless in every respect.

246. The Lord asked him the meaning of one of them
and pointed out three faults in it.

247. Unable to justify the meaning of his own verse,
the digvijayi was greatly ashamed before the Lord.

248. Yet the Lord showed him honour;
the fortunate digvijayi became absorbed in the Lord's virtues.

249. Sarasvati revealed to him who the Lord was,
and the digvijayi surrendered himself at the Lord's feet.

250. Hearing of the digvijayi's defeat by Nimai,
all the bhattacharyas were overjoyed.

251. "Nimai Pandita has defeated the digvijayi!" —
everyone everywhere was saying this.

252. My teacher and all the other scholars
gave up thinking of Him as a man — divine knowledge came to them.

253. What shall I say, my son? His pastimes are not of this world;
the greatly fortunate people of Nadia saw them.

254. For some time, merrily engaged in His sports of learning,
He went with many people to perform [the rites at] Gaya.

255. The Lord acted so to teach the people;
returning from Gaya, He began to proclaim that prema.

256. Seeing His extraordinary manifestations of prema, His students
in great joy praised Him to one another.

257. Formerly, by the Lord's will, no one recognized Him;
Srivasa and all the other devotees gave Him their blessings.

258. Having first of all shown His grace to the devotees,
Gaurahari, the lover of His devotees, could no longer hide.

259. The Lord, the enchanter of the worlds, revealed Himself,
and the devotees in great delight recognized Him.

260. Srivasa Pandita, Sri Gadadhara Pandita,
Sri Murari Gupta, the wise Haridasa,

261. Shuklambara Brahmachari and the other associates
are ceaselessly absorbed in the Lord's virtues.

262. In great merriment Advaita Gosani joined Him;
what shall I say — there is no end to His virtues.

263. Prabhu Baladeva, Nityananda the Avadhuta —
wondrous is His meeting with Gaurachandra.

264. Taking with Him Nityananda, Advaita, Srivasa and the others,
the Lord plays in Navadvipa in great merriment.

265. O my son Srinivasa, I tell you:
in this incarnation there is no limit to mercy.

266. He takes up no weapon, takes no one's life —
He delivers by giving that rarest prema.

267. The Lord's zeal is to deliver sinful unbelievers;
that is why in the age of Kali the power of the wicked is so formidable.[8]

268. Two named Jagai and Madhai, kings of robbers,
for fear of whom all the society of Nadia trembled,

269. ate nothing but meat and wine;
seeing them, no one could stay calm.

270. There was no end to the evil deeds they committed;
we too were always anxious, fearing them.

271. Seeing their outrages, the wise reflected:
"No one but God will be able to subdue them.

272. Ravana, Kamsa and the rest are no match for them" —
so they said many things to one another.

273. Those two sinners the Lord delivered,
revealing to the world the merciful Nityananda.

274. One day Gaurachandra joyfully says:
"Deliver the souls by instructing [them] about Krishna."

275. Hearing this, Prabhu Nityananda with Haridasa
go about merrily, instructing in Krishna's name.

276. Worthless students, gathering together, constantly revile [them]
and tell them to go where Jagai and Madhai are.

277. Hearing the name of Krishna, those two, enraged,
rushed at these two to beat them.

278. Madhai, drunk with wine, speaking words like a thunderbolt,
drew the blood of Nityananda-deva.

279. Even so Nityananda, the ocean of mercy,
thinks with joy in His heart of the welfare of both.

280. Hearing of this, Gaurachandra became greatly angry,
but at Nityananda's mercy He showed them mercy.

281. Nityananda and Gaurachandra are one body;
only for the sake of the pastimes are They different, all say.

282. Jagai and Madhai, clasping the Lord's feet,
said so much that it cannot be told.

283. Although the Lord, forgiving all their offences,
accepted them as His own, they still found no peace.

284. Jagai and Madhai, weeping and weeping, say:
"Give us such a command that our hearts may be at peace."

285. Hearing this, the Lord, pleased,
ordered the two to sweep the bathing ghat on the Ganga.

286. Then, regarding themselves as the lowest,
they cleaned the ghat on the Ganga day after day.

287. The two brothers became associates of the Lord;
utter their names and unbelief leaves the heart.

288. This became known to all the people:
"Nimai Pandita has delivered the great villains."

289. The worthless students, greatly amazed,
say to one another, sniggering:

290. "O brother, what does this Nimai Pandita know!
He has brought Jagai and Madhai into his company.

291. Nowhere is he seen to be defeated;
let all the people of Nadia not become like that!"

292. Someone says: "Be on your guard —
in two or four days you will see everything."

293. Saying such things, the students think themselves fortunate,
and all constantly roam about looking for faults.

294. O my son Srinivasa, with the deliverance of those two
we were all freed from fear.

295. In Navadvipa there is always a great ocean of bliss;
everyone is ceaselessly enraptured with sankirtana.

296. The unbelievers there, in all sorts of ways,
mock, threatening with the yavanas.

297. A yavana named the Kazi was very powerful:
Navadvipa and other places were under his rule.

298. The yavana king of Gauda was very fond of him;
no one dared disobey the Kazi.

299. All the people of this land trembled before him;
no one could worship God freely.

300. He opposed that rare kirtana —
and so great anger arose in the Lord.

301. One night the Lord with His devotees
was playing in Navadvipa in the merriment of sankirtana.

302. What wondrous beauty there was in the town of Nadia —
it could not be described even with a hundred thousand mouths.

303. By the Lord's will all the people of Nadia
held great auspicious festivities in every house.

304. Hundreds of thousands of lamps burned, there was endless merriment;
it seemed to everyone that night had become day.

305. Forgetting themselves, people move about everywhere;
no one can tell who is a god and who a man.

306. Hundreds of thousands of people sing kirtana together;
the sound of the drums and karatalas pierces the sky.

307. At the stamping of the dancing feet the earth sways;
a wondrous uproar of cries of "Jaya!" arose.

308. All, mighty, surpassing lions in valour,
set off crying, "Beat the Kazi, beat the Kazi!"

309. At that roar the unbelievers burst with fear;
they broke the Kazi's house, gate and flower garden.

310. The day before, the Lord, to tear open the Kazi's chest,
had become Nrisimha — the Kazi saw it with his own eyes.

311. He understood that Nimai was by no means a man
and told this to everyone.

312. Hearing this, all were saying various things to one another;
at that time a great uproar arose in the town.

313. People came and say: "That same Nimai Pandita
is singing kirtana, and there is no counting the people.

314. Crying 'Beat, beat!' they are all coming here,
breaking houses, gates and trees — we see no way out."

315. Hearing these words, the Kazi in great fear
went to the Lord with tears in his eyes.

316. Seeing the Lord, he surrendered himself;
how he praised Him cannot be told.

317. Gaurasundara, the Purifier of the fallen,
showed mercy to the fortunate Kazi.

318. Hearing these wondrous accounts, respectable people
knew for certain that Gaurachandra is Narayana.

319. So the Lord plays merrily in Navadvipa;
hearing of all this, my heart is in torment.

320. I resolved: returning from Yajigrama,
I shall go to Navadvipa and see Sri Gaurachandra.

321. Quickly settling my affairs in Yajigrama,
I came with great joy to Kantaka-nagara.

322. There was Sri Bharati Svami, full of great radiance;
he was very kind to me.

323. Whenever I went to Yajigrama or Kantaka-nagara,
I would see him, and sometimes I stayed with him.

324. I had resolved that, after taking leave of him,
I would go to Navadvipa to see Gaura.

325. With this thought I am going there —
when suddenly I see people running:

326. children, old people, youths, women and men by the hundreds,
such a crush that one could not pass along the road.

327. When I ask, they say: "We are going to Bharati's house:
Sri Gaurasundara has come from Nadia."

328. Hearing this, I felt as if I had got the moon in my hands,
and went to Sri Keshava Bharati Svami.

329. I gazed my fill at Sri Gaurasundara:
the beauty of every limb of His enchants the worlds.

330. What are golden champaka, lightning, saffron!
That form has no comparison in all the world.

331. His beautiful curling hair intoxicates the world;
who would not lose his head at the radiance of His cheeks and forehead?

332. Most beautiful ears and brows,
eyes reaching to the ears, a captivating nose.

333. His moon-face surpasses millions upon millions of moons;
the moment one sees it, the sufferings of millions of births go away.

334. Two arms reaching to the knees, a broad chest,
a waist more slender than a lion cub's.

335. Sweet are His hips; at the curve of His thighs and feet
millions upon millions of Kandarpas cannot stand firm.

336. Seeing the red soles of His feet, I thought:
"Hundreds of dawn suns must have taken refuge there."

337. O my son Srinivasa, what shall I tell you!
I drowned in the ocean of nectar of Gora's form.

338. There one person carefully asks another:
"Why has Gaurachandra come here?"

339. He says: "He will accept sannyasa;
His hair, which enchants the worlds, will vanish."

340. Hearing these words, my heart stopped,
and at that moment I saw that the barber was already there.

341. How the barber did his barber's work —
who, seeing it, could keep his composure?

342. From the Lord's head the hair vanished;
a wailing arose that filled the world."

343. Saying this, the best of brahmanas
fainted, and tears flowed from his eyes without cease.

344. Hearing this account from his father's lips,
Srinivasa weeps in great distress.

345. After some time the brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa
sighs, repeating: "The beautiful curling hair!"

346. With great effort mastering himself, he opens his eyes
and sees: his son is weeping, fallen on the ground.

347. In rapture the brahmana takes his son on his lap
and blesses him: "Be merciful to him, Gaurahari!"

348. Brushing the dust from his body and wiping away his tears,
he calms him with many words like nectar.

349. Lovingly he told everything about
how he had seen the Lord in Nilachala.

350. Telling how the Lord plays in Nilachala,
he sheds streams of tears.

351. He told of the lives of Nityananda and Advaita,
he related the lives of the Lord's associates,

352. he told how the Lord plays in Vraja
and for what purpose He descended in Navadvipa.

353. Hearing all this from his father's lips,
Srinivasa loses his composure and cannot stand.

354. Great in his heart is the longing to hear of Gauranga's pastimes:
he begs the Creator for hundreds of thousands of ears.

355. His eyes, red with love, shed tears;
again and again he bows at his father's feet.

356. Forgetting himself in the rapture of prema,
Srinivasa questions his father day after day.

357. One day the venerable brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa
says to his son with a heart full of love:

358. "My son, you have become able to care for your mother;
together with your mother I entrust everything to you.

359. Now, leaving you with your mother in Yajigrama,
I am thinking of going soon to Vrindavana.

360. In Vrindavana, through Rupa, Sanatana and others,
Prabhu Gaura-raya accomplished extraordinary things.

361. My son, the lives of those two are wondrous;
seeing them, one could never think they are mere men.

362. When I saw the two of them,
at that time I did not have such understanding.

363. Now I consider myself blessed;
I shall tell briefly how I saw them.

364. The teachers of Navadvipa and other places
almost all used to go to the village of Ramakeli.

365. My teacher, the foremost in Chakhandi —
people came from Ramakeli to fetch him.

366. The teacher set out, and we went with him;
at an auspicious moment we entered the village of Ramakeli.

367. Near the house of Sanatana and Rupa
lodgings were given to all with great honour.

368. The teachers, with great joy at heart,
went to the assembly of Sanatana and Rupa.

369. Surrounded by brahmanas and pandits,
they sit in the midst of the assembly, like Indra.

370. Their bodies are beautiful as gold, full of radiance;
who, seeing the beauty of the two, could stay composed?

371. What a gentle smile on their faces — the limit of happiness!
What creator fashioned those long eyes?

372. What captivating arms, chests, waists!
There is no comparison for them; they are beautiful in every way.

373. Going with the teacher, we saw them face to face;
they showed honour to all in every way.

374. The utmost limit of wealth — and not a trace of pride;
everywhere they beg for bhakti to Krishna's lotus feet.

375. Both brothers are supreme scholars of all the shastras;
it is known that the elder is Sanatana and the younger Rupa.

376. They listen to the expositions of the shastras by pandits from many lands
and, giving much money, please everyone.

377. Hearing their expositions of the shastras, the teacher
praised them so that I know not how to tell it.

378. Both are great ministers, foremost in the affairs of state;
in nothing do they leave anyone without honour.

379. The good fortune of the king of Gauda cannot be put into words:
he loves Sanatana and Rupa greatly.

380. I also heard from people that all this is true;
seeing their conduct, who would not be enraptured?

381. Having stayed there some days, taking his leave,
the teacher set out with joy in his heart.

382. Sanatana and Rupa are content in every way;
how famous in the world is their Vaishnava conduct!

383. From Ramakeli we soon returned home;
a few days after that came the Lord's sannyasa.

384. Having accepted sannyasa, the Lord went to Nilachala;
the Vaishnavas do not leave Him for a moment.

385. The crest-jewel of sannyasis, the son of Shachi,
set out from Nilachala for Vrindavana.

386. Coming with His associates to the village of Ramakeli,
He showed great mercy to Sanatana and Rupa.

387. He did not go to Vraja then, but returned to the Kshetra,
and later set out again for Vrindavana.

388. Here, in the village of Ramakeli, Rupa and Sanatana
heard that Mahaprabhu had gone to Vrindavana.

389. What shall I say of the strong anuraga of the two?
Without effort they gave up everything.

390. Sri Rupa's brother was named Sri Vallabha;
a great Vaishnava, his former name was Anupama.[9]

391. With him Rupa set out first for Vraja
and met Sri Krishna Chaitanya-chandra at Prayaga.

392. What joy the Lord felt on seeing Sri Rupa,
and what mercy He showed, the fortunate saw.

393. Sanatana Gosvami, meanwhile, here in Ramakeli,
set out secretly for Vraja.

394. Coming to Kashi, he saw the Lord's feet;
I do not know what ocean of happiness surged up in him.

395. Mahaprabhu Sri Krishna Chaitanya, the Lord of all,
seeing Sanatana, was overwhelmed with affection.

396. With joy in His heart [the Lord] gave him much instruction
and revealed to Sanatana the utmost limit of mercy.

397. That Sanatana and Rupa had gone to Vraja
everyone in these lands heard.

398. No one could restrain himself in any way;
all were greatly astonished:

399. "How could they give up such wealth?" —
day and night everyone says.

400. Women and men, children, the old and the young —
all repeat: "Rupa and Sanatana have gone to Vraja."

401. The teachers, without Rupa and Sanatana,
left Ramakeli in sorrow for other places.

402. The renunciation of Sanatana and Rupa grieved everyone;
only the devotees of Krishna were happy.

403. In Vrindavana the acharyas Sri Rupa and Sanatana —
the two of them — revealed what was in the Lord's heart.

404. Having revealed the lost tirthas on the evidence of the shastras,
Sri Rupa Gosani pondered one thing:

405. "The Deity Sri Govinda, the son of the king of Vraja,
always abides on the yogapitha — so the shastras declare.

406. But I cannot find the darshan of such a Sri Govinda-deva."
He goes from village to village, from forest to forest.

407. Searching in every house of the people of Vraja,
he sits on the bank of the Yamuna, having lost all peace.

408. One day, unexpectedly, a resident of Vraja
appeared before Sri Rupa Gosvami.

409. Very handsome, in a sweet voice
he says to Sri Rupa: "Svami, why are you sad?"

410. His sweet words drew the heart,
and Sri Rupa Gosvami told him everything in order.

411. The resident of Vraja says: "Do not be troubled in mind:
in Vrindavana there is a yogapitha known as Gomatila.

412. There a fine cow every day before noon
gives her milk with joy in her heart.

413. Sri Govinda-deva is hidden there."
Saying this, he led Rupa to that place.

414. Having shown the place, he vanished —
and Rupa fell unconscious to the ground.

415. After some time, coming to his senses, Rupa
cannot stop the ceaseless tears.

416. Sri Rupa Gosvami, deep as millions of oceans,
understood the Lord's secret and grew calm.

417. With joy in his heart he says to the people of Vraja:
"Lord Sri Govinda-deva is here."

418. Hearing this, the people of Vraja were overwhelmed with prema;
all, from children to old men, came to Gomatila.

419. Smiling, they say to one another:
"We have learned that Gomatila is the yogapitha."

420. When they were carefully digging the ground of the yogapitha,
Balarama commanded: "Look in the middle."

421. In the middle of the yogapitha the Lord, the son of the king of Vraja,
the enchanter of millions of Kandarpas, appeared in person.

422. *Thus [it is said] in the Sri Sadhana-dipika of Sri Radha-Krishna Gosvami, a disciple of Sri Haridasa Pandita Gosvami of Vraja:*
"To carry out the Lord's command the sage went to Vrindavana, but did not find the holy form there and pondered in his heart.

423. *Not seeing [Him] in the houses of the people of Vraja, nor in the forests, nor in the villages, the wise one wept and pondered.*

424. *One day, as he sat on the pure bank of the Yamuna, someone handsome came in the guise of a resident of Vraja.*

425. *Seeing him, he said: 'O master, why are you sad?' Hearing his words, [Rupa], his mind drawn by affection,*

426. *freed from weariness of mind by his voice, deep with prema, told him everything — that command of Mahaprabhu.*

427. *Having heard it all, he said, 'Come,' led him to the place known as Gumattila, and said again:*

428. *'Here before noon comes the best of cows and, pouring out her milk, goes away day after day.*

429. *Consider this, master, and do what is fitting; I am going.' Sri Rupa, hearing his words and seeing his form, fainted.*

430. *After a while, the wise one, collecting himself and reflecting — though he knew the whole secret, yet acting in the way of ordinary people —*

431. *said to the people of Vraja: 'Sri Govinda is here.' Hearing this, all of them, their hearts melted with prema,*

432. *together with children and old men cleared that ground — and, at the command of Rama: 'Look: in the middle of the yogapitha is Krishna, the Lord, the son of the king of Vraja Himself, the enchanter of millions of Manmathas,' — they carefully dug up that ground."*[10]

433. As soon as the word spread of Sri Govinda-deva's appearance,
countless people come running joyfully from all sides.

434. Brahma and the other gods, mingling with the people,
in supreme joy take the darshan of Govinda.

435. Not for a moment does the crowd thin;
no one can make out who comes from where.

436. As soon as Govinda appeared, Sri Rupa Gosani
sent a letter to Mahaprabhu in the Kshetra.

437. Sri Krishna Chaitanya Prabhu with His associates,
reading the letter, cannot contain Himself for joy.

438. The Lord says to Kashishvara in private:
"You will have to go to Vrindavana."

439. Kashishvara says: "Prabhu, to leave You —
my heart breaks; do what is fitting."

440. Gaurahari, understanding Kashishvara's heart,
carefully gave him a Deity — His own form.

441. The Lord ate rice and other food together with that Deity;
seeing this, Kashishvara was filled with supreme joy.

442. The Lord told the name — Sri Gaura-Govinda;
with Him Kashishvara came to Vrindavana.

443. Placing the Lord at the right of Sri Govinda,
overcome with prema, he performs wondrous service.

444. *Thus [it is said] in the Sri Sadhana-dipika — an account heard from the lips of an associate of Mahaprabhu:*
"Once Sri Mahaprabhu said to Sri Kashishvara: 'Go to Vrindavana and live near Sri Rupa and Sanatana.' Hearing this, he was both delighted and astonished. The crest-jewel of the omniscient, Gaura, knowing his heart, said again: 'Bring the Deity of Sri Krishna that stands beside Jagannatha, and know that I am non-different from Him, Bhagavan Himself; serve Him thus.' Hearing this, he fell silent. Then Sri Krishna in the form of the Deity and Mahaprabhu ate together. After this Sri Kashishvara, bowing down like a rod, brought the Deity of Gaura-Govinda to Vrindavana. This is the Mahaprabhu beside Sri Govinda."[11]

445. *[And again:]*
"May Gaura-Govinda be merciful to me, who by the lustre of His feet has conquered Madana, by the lustre of His face has crushed the pride of the lotus and the jewel, and whose feet are the shelter of Sri Rupa."

446. Govinda's pastimes are truly wondrous and boundless;
who can understand them without His mercy?

447. The pastimes are of two kinds — manifest and unmanifest;
in the unmanifest He plays in the form of a silent [Deity].

448. O Srinivasa, how much shall I tell you?
Sri Govinda appeared through Rupa.

449. Sri Vrinda revealed herself to Sri Rupa in a dream,
and he manifested her from the bank of Brahma-kunda.

450. Boundless are the beauty and greatness of Sri Vrinda-devi;
if she is merciful, every undertaking is accomplished.

451. *Thus [it is said] in the Sri Sadhana-dipika:*
"On the edge of the bank of Brahma-kunda Vrinda-devi was manifested by Sri Rupa, the ocean of mercy, by the power of the Lord's command.

452. *I praise Vrinda, the goddess, who wears on her head a crown of beautiful jewels, shining golden earrings on both ears, charming necklaces, a girdle, smiling, with armlets and bracelets, ankle-bells and the rest — fair-faced, within Vrindavana, beside Srila Govinda.*

453. *The lotus feet of Sri Vrinda are honoured with bhakti by all the gods and sages and served with love; they remove the taint of Kali and grant every desire. What more is there to say? Whoever worships them lives in this Sri Vrindavana, unattainable even for the dwellers of heaven, free from all sorrows."*

454. O Srinivasa, how many deeds of Sri Rupa
can I tell with one mouth?

455. Wondrous are the pastimes of Sanatana Gosvami:
from time to time he lives in Sri Mahavana.

456. There he sees with his own eyes how Madana-gopala
plays with the boys on the sandbank of the Yamuna.

457. Madana-gopala, subject to Sanatana's love,
one day in the guise of a dream says to Sanatana:

458. "Sanatana, your hut pleases Me;
I shall come here from Mahavana."

459. Saying this, the Lord vanished;
Sanatana was beside himself with prema.

460. The devotee knows well the Lord's designs:
at dawn Madana-gopala came.

461. Sanatana's heart became boundlessly glad;
in a hut of leaves he serves the Lord.

462. Sri Madanamohana is the son of a great king,
yet He eats dry flatbread — Sanatana grieves.

463. Knowing Sanatana's thoughts, Madana-gopala
at once wished His service to be enlarged.

464. At that time a certain man from the land of Multan,
very wealthy and skilful in every way —

465. the best of kshatriyas, a Kapur named Krishnadasa —
stepping off a boat, came to the Gosvami.

466. He fell at the Gosvami's feet, rolling on the ground,
and humbled himself greatly, bathed in tears.

467. Sanatana showed him great mercy
and entrusted him to the feet of Sri Madanamohana.

467a. Seeing Sri Madanamohana, Krishnadasa
falls to the ground and bows, sighing deeply.[12]

468. That very day he began to build the temple
and had [the Deity] adorned with various jewels.

469. Garments and other things of every kind
he had carefully kept in a separate storeroom.

470. He prepared all kinds of provisions for offerings:
"The Lord will eat," — and he was very glad.

471. Who, seeing Madana-gopala, can keep his composure?
The people of Vraja float in an ocean of happiness.

472. I have told this healing story briefly:
Madanamohana is the life of Sanatana.

473. My son Srinivasa, what more is there to say?
The Lord revealed Himself through His devotees.

474. Paramananda Bhattacharya Mahashaya
and Sri Madhu Pandita are abodes of virtue.

475. Krishna, the son of the king of Vraja, is subject to the love of both;
their doings are unfathomable — who is able to tell of them?

476. Near Vamshivata there is a most beautiful place;
there Gopinatha plays in great merriment.

477. *Thus [it is said] in the Sri Sadhana-dipika:*
"By him (Madhu Pandita) was manifested Gopinatha, the ocean of mercy, at Vamshivata, on the auspicious bank of the beautiful Yamuna."[13]

479. Suddenly [Gopinatha] mercifully gave him darshan,
and Sri Madhu Pandita received the right to serve [Him].

480. Sri Paramananda Bhattacharya Mahashaya
loves Madhu Pandita dearly.

481. O Srinivasa, what joy there is in Vrindavana
at the darshan of Gopinatha — who can tell?

482. With the radiance of His body He steals the hearts of all;
hundreds of thousands of people run to have His darshan.

483. Beautiful and sweet is the life of Sri Gopinatha;
whoever hears of it even once, his sufferings go far away.

484. Of Sri Vraja I have heard from the lips of devotees;
it is very extensive — I have told you a little.

485. O Srinivasa, how my soul longs!
Will there be such a day when I go to Vrindavana?"

486. Saying this, Sri Chaitanya Dasa
sheds streams of tears and cannot stop them.

487. Holding his father's feet, Srinivasa weeps,
saying to himself: "Will my hope be fulfilled?"

488. Father and son grew calm only after some time;
who knows how wondrous the might of prema is!

489. Apart from talk of Krishna nothing pleases them;
such a father and son have no comparison.

490. Whoever listens to this conversation of father and son
attains without effort the rarest wealth of bhakti.

491. Meditating on the feet of Srinivasa Acharya,
Narahari Dasa tells the Bhakti-ratnakara.

Thus in the Sri Bhakti-ratnakara, in the account of the birth of Srinivasa and other matters, ends the second wave, called "The Description of the Appearance of Sri Govinda and the Other [Deities] in Vrindavana".

1. Kantaka-nagara is Katwa; Sri Bharati is Keshava Bharati, the Lord's sannyasa-guru. Cf. CB Madhya 28; CC Adi 17.

2. Cf. the Prema-vilasa (vilasa 1): there the childlessness of Chaitanya Dasa and the gift of a son are told differently — through Jagannatha and the Lord's command to the Earth.

3. Chaitanya Dasa's vision: Krishna-Shyamasundara; Gaura in the dress of a householder; Gaura the sannyasi; Jagannatha with Baladeva and Subhadra.

4. Patita-pavana ("Purifier of the Fallen") is the Deity of Jagannatha at the Lion Gate of the temple in Puri.

5. The 1960 edition has "in the muhurta of Rohini". According to the Prema-vilasa, Srinivasa's birth is told differently; cf. PV, vilasas 1–2.

6. GGD: Narahari Sarakara is Madhumati, a friend of Radha in Vraja.

7. A pun: "shri-khanda" means both the name of the village and sandal.

8. So in the 1912/13 edition ("papa-pashandi tarite"); in the 1960 edition the line is corrupt. Cf. CB Madhya 13 (the deliverance of Jagai and Madhai) and Madhya 23 (the subduing of the Kazi).

9. Cf. 1.665, where it is said that the name Anupama was given to him by Sri Gaurasundara.

10. Verses 422–432, from the Sadhana-dipika of Radha-Krishna Gosvami, repeat the account of 404–421 in Sanskrit. "Gumattila" is the same as Gomatila.

11. A prose passage from the Sadhana-dipika. According to this account, the Deity of Gaura-Govinda stands in Vrindavana to the right of Govinda-deva.

12. This couplet stands at this place in the editions of 1888 and 1912/13; in the 1960 edition it is misplaced after verse 477 under the number 478, so the number 478 is skipped here.

13. Gopinatha is the Deity manifested by Madhu Pandita at Vamshivata; Paramananda Bhattacharya (474) is his elder friend and fellow student.

Taranga 3. Srinivasa's Journey to Nilachala and Return to Gauda

Srinivasa's boyhood in Chakhandi; his father's death and the move to Yajigrama; Srinivasa sets out for Nilachala via Shrikhanda; Advaita's riddle; news of the Lord's disappearance; consolation in a dream; Srinivasa with Gadadhara Pandita and the Lord's associates in Puri; return to Gauda, news of the disappearance of Gadadhara, Nityananda and Advaita; arrival in Navadvipa

1. Glory to Sri Gaurasundara, the Moon of Navadvipa!
Glory to Nityananda the Avadhuta, Haladhara!

2. Glory to Advaita, the Lord, the Master of Shantipura!
Glory to Sri Gadadhara Pandita, dear to Gaura!

3. Glory, glory to Srivasa Pandita Thakura!
Glory to Haridasa, absorbed in the nectar of Hari-nama!

4. Glory to Sri Svarupa Damodara, full of prema!
Glory to Sri Murari Gupta, the ocean of virtues!

5. Glory to Vasudeva Sarvabhauma Mahashaya!
Glory to Raya Ramananda, the abode of rasa!

6. Glory to Gauridasa and Sri Vakreshvara Pandita!
Glory to Narahari, Sri Mukunda and Kashishvara!

7. Glory to Jagadisha, Gauridasa and Dhananjaya!
Glory to Sanatana and Rupa, abodes of virtue!

8. Glory to Jiva, Gopala, Bhugarbha and Lokanatha!
Glory to Raghunatha Bhatta, renowned in the world!

9. Glory to Raghunatha Dasa, who dwells at Sri Kunda!
Glory, glory to Sri Raghava, who dwells at Govardhana!

10. Glory to Srinivasa, Narottama and Ramachandra!
Glory to Shyamananda, the life of the poor and suffering!

11. Glory to my Sri Thakura, the Gosani of the Vaishnavas:[1]
singing his virtues, the world is purified!

12. Glory, glory to the listeners, abodes of virtue!
Now listen with kind hearts to what I shall tell.

13. Srinivasa's heart is absorbed in Gaura's virtues;
he serves his father and mother without cease.

14. How his father and mother loved their son
I have no power to tell.

15. What joy in every house of the village of Chakhandi!
They cannot be parted from Srinivasa for a moment.

16. Srinivasa pleases everyone in every way,
and all praise Srinivasa with joy.

17. How Srinivasa spends his time in Chakhandi —
is it possible to tell it with one mouth?

18. After some time his father left this world;
looking at her son's face, his mother forgot her grief.

19. A few days later Srinivasa Mahashaya
went to Yajigrama, to his maternal grandfather's house.

20. Together with his mother he decided:
"Now it is fitting to live in Yajigrama."

21. All the villagers, hearing this,
joyfully prepared a place for them to live.

22. In Yajigrama and the villages around everyone rejoices:
Srinivasa became dearer to all than life.

23. Srinivasa is ceaselessly absorbed in the rasa of bhakti;
seeing this, Chaitanya's dear associates are overjoyed.

24. Srinivasa constantly stays with the devotees
and hears of Chaitanya's pastimes in every detail.

25. How the Lord with His associates plays in Nilachala —
hearing of it, his heart overflows.

26. Srinivasa, great of spirit, grew restless
and firmly resolved to go to Nilachala.

27. How many longings arise in his heart each moment:
"Will the Lord give His darshan to a wretch like me?

28. Will the Lord's devotees show me mercy?
Shall I be able to place the dust of their feet on my head?

29. Will Sri Gadadhara Pandita keep such an unworthy one as me
forever near his feet?

30. When the Lord listens to the Srimad Bhagavatam,
will the words from His mouth enter my ears?

31. Shall I see Nilachala-chandra Jagannatha
with Sri Subhadra-devi and Lord Balarama?"

32. So he says many things, and tears flow from both his eyes;
after a while, growing calm, he set out for Khanda.

33. Seeing the Deity, he bowed again and again,
and tears flowed from his eyes without cease.

34. To the dear associates of Sri Gaurachandra
he bows again and again, falling to the ground.

35. Sri Narahari Thakura, in the rapture of prema,
opening his arms, embraced Srinivasa.

36. Lovingly he bathes Srinivasa's body with tears
and asks after his welfare, as if pouring out nectar.

37. Srinivasa says: "I shall go to Nilachala;
allow me to go and see His lotus feet."

38. Hearing this, [the Thakura], deeply troubled,
said: "Go quickly; there must be no delay."

39. And he said further to Srinivasa in a faltering voice:
"The Lord is about to conceal these pastimes.

40. Advaita Acharya sent a riddle;
in that riddle-charade he expressed what was in his heart.

41. *Thus [it is said] in the Chaitanya-charitamrita, in the nineteenth chapter of the Antya-lila:*
'Tell the madman: the people have gone mad;
tell the madman: rice no longer sells in the market;

42. tell the madman: there is no more madness in the work;
tell the madman: the madman has said this.'[2]

43. The meaning of the riddle the Lord expressed in another way,
and from then on all the devotees have been anxious.

44. He is the independent Lord; who can fathom His design?
I do not know when He will plunge [the world] into darkness."

45. Having said this, he was bathed in tears;
seeing Srinivasa distressed, he comforted him.

46. At once he gave him all he needed for the road;
the Thakura's love — who can describe it?

47. Sri Raghunandana came there
and, embracing Srinivasa, was overcome with prema.

48. With all the devotees of the Lord who lived in Khanda
he met as was fitting.

49. Quickly taking leave of all,
he came to Yajigrama and told his mother everything.

50. Taking leave of his mother with due respect,
he set out for Nilachala to see the Lord.

51. At an auspicious moment, on the fifth day of the bright fortnight of Magha,
Srinivasa set out with joy in his heart.

52. He is in the age of kaishora, his body very beautiful;
whoever sees him even once cannot stay calm.

53. Someone says: "He is the son of some king;
he walks on foot — great is his love."

54. Someone says: "He is one of Gaura's associates;
otherwise why do tears flow from his eyes without cease?"

55. Someone says: "There is no doubt about it:
Gauranga Gosani can do anything."

56. Someone says: "Ah, seeing that Gorachand,
who — man or woman — can keep calm?"

57. Someone says: "Gaurachandra is the son of the king of Vraja;
in Nilachala I saw His wondrous pastimes."

58. Someone says: "There is no limit to the good fortune of Utkala:
two Lords, the moving and the unmoving, are in one place."

59. Someone says: "Gaura and Jagannatha are one;
whoever sees a difference between Them perishes."

60. So many travellers speak,
and seeing Srinivasa's conduct they shed tears.

61. In blissful rapture Srinivasa walks on;
to those coming from the Kshetra he bows

62. and asks for news of the Lord and the devotees;
hearing this news, he rejoices without measure.

63. He begs the Lord for wings to fly there;
day and night he walks the road, knowing no fatigue.

64. With joy in his heart Srinivasa was walking —
and on the way he heard that Chaitanya had disappeared.

65. "Mahaprabhu is no longer to be seen" — hearing these words,
what he became — who could describe?

66. Hundreds of times he strikes his head,
tears out his hair, rakes his chest with his nails.

67. Weeping and weeping, he curses himself;
at his laments stones melt.

68. Again and again he falls unconscious to the ground;
at the sight of his tears everyone's heart breaks.

69. In great torment the day ended;
he firmly resolved: "I will not keep life in this body.

70. I shall build a fire and enter it —
then this cruel anguish of mine will end."

71. While he pondered thus, four dandas of the night passed;
repeating the Lord's name, he weeps aloud.

72. By the Lord's will sleep overcame him,
and in the guise of a dream Gaurachandra gave him darshan:

73. His beautiful body surpasses a mass of lightning,
His face surpasses millions of moons,

74. His large eyes reach to His ears,
His arms reach to His knees, at His neck a garland of forest flowers.

75. With His sweet smile He pours out streams of nectar;
who, seeing that beauty even once, could stay composed?

76. The Lord who loves His devotees, the enchanter of the worlds,
appearing in the guise of a dream, saved his life.

77. He placed His feet on Srinivasa's head
and in the rapture of prema comforted him greatly.

78. *Thus [it is said] in the Nava-padya of Sri Nrisimha Kaviraja:*
"Sri Srinivasa, having resolved to go to Sri Purushottama, hearing from people's lips of the disappearance of Prabhu Chaitanya, the ocean of mercy, fainted again and again from floods of grief; and then Bhagavan, seeing the anguish of His devotee, with great consolation and mercy

instructed him in a dream."[3]

79. Having shown Srinivasa His fatherly love, Bhagavan
stayed [with him] a while in the dream and vanished.

80. When the Lord vanished the sleep broke,
and the waves of the ocean of the grief of separation rose high.

81. Seeing Srinivasa in great grief, Gaurahari
again, in the guise of a dream, speaks softly:

82. "Gadadhara and My other dear associates
are anxiously watching the road for you.

83. Do not delay; go quickly to Nilachala."
Saying this, He wiped away his tears with His own hand.

84. Embracing him again and again with great love,
the Lord, the son of Shachi, vanished.

85. Waking and seeing that the night had passed,
Srinivasa walks on, meditating on the Lord's feet.

86. After some days Srinivasa came to Nilachala;
seeing [the pond] Sri Narendra-shaucha, he burst into tears.

87. Sri Narendra was a king, Shaucha his great minister;
the pond is known by the names of these two.[4]

88. Mahaprabhu used to hold water-sports in Narendra —
he had heard of this earlier in Gauda.

89. Thinking of this, he lost his composure
and wept for a long time, sitting on the bank.

90. The ocean of prema surged up; he cannot calm himself,
he rolls on the ground — who can understand his behaviour?

91. Coming back to himself, bathed in tears,
he bowed to Narendra and slowly walked on.

92. It was already late; after some thought
he stayed at a spot near the Lion Gate.

93. Overcome with prema, he performs nama-sankirtana;
tears flow from his eyes like the current of a river.

94. Unable to stay on his feet, he rolls on the ground;
by the Lord's will sleep overcame him.

95. Jagannatha with Balarama and Subhadra
mercifully appeared to him in the guise of a dream.

96. What wondrous fatherly love! Who can understand such play?
He gazed his fill — and the sleep broke.

97. Srinivasa was thrown into great turmoil;
at that time a certain brahmana came there.

98. He says: "My son, son of a brahmana,
you are burning with grief and have not eaten.

99. Take Sri mahaprasada and eat."
Giving him the prasada, he vanished.

100. Srinivasa, agitated, thinks to himself:
"How did he know of this grief of mine?

101. Having given me Sri mahaprasada,
he vanished before my eyes."

102. At these thoughts his heart grew anxious,
and the Lord, appearing almost in person, comforted him.

103. By the mercy of Lord Jagannatha, with joy in his heart,
he at once ate the Sri mahaprasada.

104. In his pot he had water from Narendra-shaucha;
carefully washing his hands, he drank it.

105. Softly he sings the sankirtana of the Lord's name,
and after a while sleep overcame him a little.

106. In a dream he sees Sri Gaura surrounded by His associates,
like Purandara among the gods.

107. Before the Lord sits Gadadhara Pandita
and reads the Bhagavata, pouring out streams of nectar.

108. All are adorned with tears, trembling and other bhavas —
such beauty Srinivasa beholds.

109. All the desires of his heart were fulfilled;
after some time, waking, he was greatly saddened.

110. The Mahashaya again sings nama-sankirtana,
and again suddenly sleep overcomes him a little.

111. Again in a dream he sees, along that same road by the Lion Gate,
Gaurachandra coming with His associates.

112. His golden body surpasses a golden mountain,
His arms reach to His knees, the curves of His body are captivating.

113. How many moons rise in His face!
He smiles gently, ever pouring out nectar.

114. His two lotus eyes reach to His ears,
full of tears of prema, and they tremble.

115. At His neck is a tulasi garland that enchants the worlds;
He wears an incomparable cloth the colour of dawn.

116. The quarters shine with the beauty of His body;
intoxicated with His own prema, He walks like a lion.

117. As soon as he saw such beauty, he was enraptured,
he cannot stay on his feet, he sways.

118. Rolling on the ground, he falls at the Lord's feet;
the Lord looks at His servant with compassionate eyes.

119. Smiling, the Lord says: "Grieve no more:
I always rest in your heart."

120. Saying this, the Merciful One vanished;
waking, he sees that morning has come.

121. With great effort composing himself,
he asks someone the way and goes to Markandeya.[5]

122. Having performed his morning duties, he bathed in Markandeya;
looking at Srinivasa, everyone gladdens his eyes.

123. Bowing to Markandeya, Srinivasa walks on;
there, in great agitation, he asks an old man:

124. "Where is Gadadhara Pandita Gosvami?"
He says: "I shall take you to where he is."

125. Saying this, he walks ahead of Srinivasa,
turning back again and again to look at Srinivasa.

126. He pointed out the beautiful flower garden of Sri Gopinatha:
"Here lives Gadadhara.

127. Go, my son; what shall I tell you of his condition?
In separation from the Lord he can barely keep his life.

128. The Kshetra has become empty — bitter is our lot."
Saying this, the noble old brahmana went away.

129. Srinivasa, seeing how sorrowful his heart was,
bowed to him and thanked him warmly.

130. Hastening before Sri Gopinatha,
he bows again and again, rolling on the ground.

131. Unblinking, he gazes at the beautiful face [of Gopinatha];
his whole body became filled with tears and trembling.

132. Seeing Srinivasa, all eagerly ask:
"Whose son are you, what is your name, where have you come from?"

133. Hearing this, he answers: "I have come from Gauda;
my name is Srinivasa, I am the son of the brahmana Chaitanya."

134. As soon as they heard these words they were flooded with tears of prema,
and all ran up and embraced Srinivasa.

135. Someone went to Sri Pandita Gosvami;
he was sitting alone in complete solitude.

136. In what wondrous state he was cannot be told;
only one who saw him then knows.

137. His beautiful body, which surpassed gold,
had grown pale, like the moon by day.

138. His face, which the moon longed to behold,
had withered like a lotus without water.

139. From his red lotus eyes tears flow without cease,
bathing all his tender body.

140. Before him is the Sri Bhagavata, and it is soaked with tears;
he remembers nothing — fire burns in his heart.

141. His voice breaks as he recites the verses;
the great-hearted Pandita cannot calm himself.

142. Crying "Sri Gaurasundara!", he closes his eyes
and heaves long sighs like flames.

143. What Sri Gadadhara Pandita became in separation from Gauranga
is beyond the reach [even] of the Lord.[6]

144. Only to show mercy to Srinivasa
does life linger in his motionless body.

145. By the Lord's will he came to himself a little,
and at that moment someone said with joined palms:

146. "Srinivasa has come from Sri Gauda,
whose father is the brahmana Sri Chaitanya Dasa."

147. Hearing this, he says: "Bring him — let my eyes be gladdened," —
and Srinivasa was brought at once.

148. Srinivasa, looking at Prabhu Gadadhara,
falls to the ground and bows, tears streaming from his eyes.

149. Pandita Gosvami, seeing Srinivasa,
rose quickly, opening his arms,

150. and with the words "Come, my son!" lifted and embraced him,
and bathed Srinivasa with his tears.

151. With great fatherly love seating him beside himself,
he calmed Srinivasa with the sweetest words.

152. Although he is in great grief in separation from Sri Prabhu,
still, seeing Srinivasa, he feels joy.

153. He carefully instructs, giving him one of his own people as companion:
"Take Srinivasa to everyone and introduce him."

154. Meanwhile the devotees heard from one another
that Srinivasa had come to the Pandita.

155. All long to see Srinivasa;
Srinivasa went to the house of Sarvabhauma.

156. Sri Raya Ramananda came there too;
sitting together, the two sing the virtues of Gaurachandra.

157. Srinivasa came and saw them both;
falling to the ground, he honoured the feet of both.

158. Both of them are drowning in an ocean of great grief,
but seeing Srinivasa, they felt joy in their hearts.

159. Both rose and embraced Srinivasa,
bathing Srinivasa with tears of prema.

160. Again and again Srinivasa falls at their feet,
ceaselessly drowning in the tears of both his eyes.

161. Seeing Srinivasa's state, both weep
and embrace Srinivasa again and again.

162. The fatherly love of the two cannot be told:
taking his hands, both seat him beside them.

163. Both, great-hearted, with the sweetest words
after a while calmed Srinivasa.

164. To the one who was with him they say gently:
"Bring Srinivasa, dear to us as life, to meet everyone."

165. With a troubled heart Srinivasa went
to where Vakreshvara Pandita was sitting.

166. Falling to the ground, he bowed at his lotus feet;
seeing Srinivasa, Sri Pandita was glad.

167. With the words "Come, my son!" he lifted and embraced him
and bathed Srinivasa's body with his tears.

168. With great fatherly love he seated him nearby
and, laying his hand on his body, speaks nectarean words:

169. "It is good that you came quickly — I have seen you:
the Lord will accomplish much through you."

170. Having said this, the Mahashaya lost his composure
and with great fatherly love embraces him again and again.

171. Although he cannot part with Srinivasa,
still he told him to go and meet everyone.

172. Srinivasa, bowing again at his feet,
went on, tears streaming from both his eyes.

173. Sri Paramananda [Puri] and the other sannyasis
were utterly without strength in separation from the Lord.

174. None has the strength to sit up or rise;
only by the Lord's will do they remain in their bodies.

175. Like dead men, they lie in solitude,
remembering neither day nor night.

176. Srinivasa came and saw them
and with great reverence honoured the feet of each.

177. Seeing Srinivasa, all rejoiced
and, lifting him from the ground, embrace him again and again.

178. Finding Srinivasa, they were as if given life again,
and they bathed Srinivasa in tears of prema.

179. Srinivasa was overwhelmed with great prema;
tears flow down his face and chest.

180. After a while, calming Srinivasa,
they said: "Go, my son, meet everyone."

181. Srinivasa went to the house of Shikhi Mahiti;
there he met many people.

182. When Srinivasa bowed, all embraced him;
Srinivasa was soaked with the tears of them all.

183. Srinivasa, weeping, says something;
hearing those words, they cannot restrain themselves.

184. Kanai Khutiya says: "Listen, Srinivasa:
today you have opened the eyes of the blind."

185. Shikhi Mahiti with his sister says:
"Only to see you are we still alive."

186. Sri Pattanayaka Vaninatha and all the others,
embracing Srinivasa, say this:

187. "Stay with us a while — [then] meet everyone,
let the eyes be gladdened," — so they told Srinivasa.

188. Receiving leave, Srinivasa, with tears in his eyes,
went to see Govinda and Shankara.

189. Arriving, he sees the two sitting in solitude,
withered in separation from Gauranga — swaying in the wind.

190. Srinivasa falls to the ground before both;
both lifted Srinivasa and embraced him.

191. With troubled hearts they said many things;
on hearing of those sorrows stones melt.

192. Srinivasa weeps aloud
and, falling to the ground, loses consciousness.

193. Seeing Srinivasa's state, both calm him
and carefully say: "Go, meet everyone."

194. Srinivasa went on, finding no peace,
and saw Gopinatha Acharya.

195. Falling to the ground, he bowed at his feet;
he, his heart in great turmoil, embraced him.

196. Crying "Sri Krishna Chaitanya!", he is drowned in tears of prema
and, having embraced Srinivasa, cannot let him go.

197. Srinivasa weeps, clasping his feet;
who, seeing that state, could stay composed?

198. After some time Gopinatha, mastering himself,
calmed Srinivasa and seated him beside himself.

199. Softly he speaks words that are a stream of nectar:
"Everyone wished to see you.

200. It is now some days since the Lord disappeared;
by His will you did not come [sooner].

201. Grieve no more, dear Srinivasa:
the Lord ever abides in your heart."

202. Having said much in this way, he told him to meet everyone,
and Srinivasa went, eager to see them.

203. Thus everywhere he met [the devotees], overwhelmed with love,
and all were merciful to their dear Srinivasa.

204. What state each one was in, in separation from the Lord —
who could describe it even with hundreds of thousands of mouths?

205. As a Deity remains silent and still,
so Srinivasa saw everyone everywhere.

206. Only to show mercy to their dear Srinivasa
did life remain in their bodies in such separation.

207. Not obtaining the darshan of Svarupa and Raghunatha,
Srinivasa weeps in great distress.

208. Separation from the Lord, then the departure of Svarupa —
and in great sorrow Raghunatha went to Vrindavana.[7]

209. For this reason he could not meet him;
[Srinivasa] wept much at Svarupa's abode.

210. Seeing the place where Raghunatha had lived,
he sighs deeply, remembering his virtues.

211. Who can describe the virtues of Sri Raghunatha,
the disciple of Sri Yadunandana Acharya?

212. *Thus in the Chaitanya-chandrodaya-nataka, Act Ten, Shivananda says to those who wished to go [to Raghunatha]:*[8]
"Acharya Yadunandana, most sweet, dear to Sri Vasudeva —
his disciple named Raghunatha, rich in virtues, dearer than life to people like me,
ever moistened by the abundant mercy of Sri Chaitanya, a follower of Svarupa,
a treasury of renunciation — to whom among those living at Nilachala is he unknown?"

213. He heard the news of Prataparudra:
what his state was — who is able to tell?

214. While Lord Krishna Chaitanyachandra was still manifest,
[the king] with auspicious rites had handed the kingdom to his son.[9]

215. With Vasudeva Sarvabhauma and Ramananda
he was constantly immersed in glorifying the Lord's deeds.

216. He passed his days and nights in supreme bliss,
but suddenly anxiety seized him and he could not be at peace.

217. Then, hearing the news that the Lord had disappeared from sight,
the king, flinging himself down, rolled on the ground.

218. Striking his head with his hands, he fell unconscious;
Raya Ramananda alone preserved his life.

219. Unable to bear separation from the Lord,
the king stayed some distance away from Nilachala.

220. Hearing this, Srinivasa is bathed in tears:
he did not get the king's darshan at Nilachala.

221. Thus with many he could not meet;
he deems it his misfortune, and his grief knows no bounds.

222. Srinivasa quickly went to the seashore
and saw the samadhi of Haridasa Thakura.[10]

223. Falling to the ground, he offered many obeisances;
his body was drenched with his own tears.

224. Remembering all he had heard before of Sri Haridasa's deeds,
his heart was overwhelmed.

225. Saying, "Ha, ha, Prabhu Haridasa!"
he fell unconscious upon the earth.

226. His transcendental displays of love cannot be described;
only by the Lord's will did he regain consciousness.

227. The devotees who were at the holy samadhi
calmed Srinivasa with affectionate words.

228. Again Srinivasa bowed before the holy samadhi;
the lament he made melts the heart of those who hear it.

229. The one who had come with him carefully
brought Srinivasa quickly to the Pandita.

230. Pandita Gosani again said to him,
"Take him to see Jagannatha."

231. Srinivasa went by the road to the Lion Gate —
a wondrous effulgence, as if the sun had risen.

232. His tender body is grey with dust,
and it is ever bathed in tears from his reddened eyes.

233. Whoever looks at Srinivasa even once
loses all composure, and streams flow from his eyes.

234. Some run ahead of Srinivasa
and, standing before him, watch the beauty of his gait.

235. One says, "O brother, look at Srinivasa:
Krishna Chaitanya sports in his heart."

236. Another says, "What you have said is surely so;
otherwise would the devotees show him such affection?

237. In separation from the Lord the devotees are as if dead,
and yet on seeing Srinivasa they feel joy."

238. Another says, "To relieve our pain
Jagannatha has brought Srinivasa here."

239. Another says, "What the Lord ordered before
has now become visible to our eyes."

240. Another says, "He is so young and tender —
seeing him in this state, my heart breaks."

241. Thus they spoke of many things among themselves,
and Srinivasa came and bowed down at the Lion Gate.

242. First beholding Patita-pavana,[11]
he went on a little further, absorbed in love.

243. Ever considering himself lowly and destitute,
he offers abundant prayers to Nrisimha-deva.

244. Bowing with great care to Nrisimha-deva,
he reverently entered the holy temple.

245. Attracting the hearts of all, he stands at a distance
and gazes at Nilachala-chandra, his eyes unable to have enough.

246. The enchanting sweetness of Nilachala-chandra:
His body surpasses a mass of rain-laden clouds.

247. His lotus eyes entice the three worlds;
the beauty of His face surpasses millions of moons.

248. Most wondrous is the grace of the curve of His arms;
He is lovely, adorned with jewelled ornaments.

249. Garlands of many flowers reach down to His feet;
their beauty unfolds ever more — who can find its end?

250. A crest of many flowers adorns His charming head;
on His forehead flashes a victory over millions of Kandarpas.

251. Having thus beheld Jagannatha-deva,
he saw Baladeva-chandra, and his eyes were soothed.

252. Surpassing the moon, kunda flowers, sandal and the silver mountain,[12]
His body glitters with wondrous loveliness.

253. The beauty of His moonlike face enchants the world;
at the play of His lotus eyes Kandarpa swoons.

254. Incomparable are His arms, lovely His forehead;
He is adorned with ornaments of jewels and flowers.

255. Seeing such beauty of Balarama,
Srinivasa cannot contain himself: his joy keeps growing.

256. Beholding the lotus face of Sri Subhadra,
he gazed his fill at Chakra-Sudarshana.

257. A dear servant of Sri Jagannatha joyfully
gave Srinivasa prasada — a garland and cloth.

258. All the temples within the chakra-beda[13]
the great soul visited with great care.

259. The one who had brought Srinivasa for darshan
came with him to the abode of Gopinatha.

260. Again he beheld the lotus feet of Gopinatha
and drowned in the nectar ocean of His beauty.

261. He went again to Sri Pandita Gosvami,
who told him to honour the mahaprasada.

262. Srinivasa sits to honour the mahaprasada;
at the sight of the prasada tears stream from his eyes.

263. Perceiving its wondrous fragrance, his heart swells;
with great reverence, bowing to the ground, he eats.

264. How many names shall I list? That prasada of many kinds
Srinivasa partook of, intoxicated with the taste of bhakti.

265. After honouring the Sri mahaprasada for some time,
he went to the place of Sri Pandita Gosvami.

266. Pandita Gosani was worn away by great separation;
from both his eyes streams of love flowed incessantly.

267. Asking Srinivasa whether he had honoured the prasada,
with the greatest tenderness he seated him by his side.

268. With what wondrous affection he again speaks, haltingly:
"You had a wish to study the Bhagavata,

269. and I had a wish to teach you.
What can one say, and to whom? A contrary obstacle has arisen."

270. Having said this, he remained silent for a while;
then, composing himself, he looks at Srinivasa.

271. From time to time he explains the meaning of the Srimad-Bhagavata,
and on hearing it no doubt remains.

272. See — this is the limit of mercy to Srinivasa:
even at such a time he makes him hear it in due form.

273. Again he says to Srinivasa, "Go to Vrindavana:
there all these desires will be fulfilled.

274. The book that is here has become worn."
So saying, he brought the book and gave it to Srinivasa.

275. Srinivasa bowed to the holy book;
as he looks at the letters, tears stream from his eyes.

276. Through the tears of Sri Chaitanya Prabhu and Gadadhara
letters had been effaced here and there, and reading was impossible.[14]

277. Seeing how Srinivasa became as he looked [at it],
fear arose in the Gosani's heart.

278. With what wondrous affection, calming Srinivasa,
he bestowed his mercy on him in every way!

279. The tenderness of Sri Pandita Gosvami is marvellous,
but for fear of lengthening the book I cannot describe it.

280. He ordered Srinivasa to go to the land of Gauda
and told him to take leave of everyone quickly.

281. For Gadadhara Dasa, dear to the Pandita as his life,
he lamented greatly.[15]

282. And what he asked him to tell Narahari and all the residents of Khanda
is painful to hear.

283. Hearing such an order from the Gosvami, Srinivasa
felt as if the sky had broken and fallen on his head.

284. Unable to disobey the order, in his distress
he lamented so that the heart breaks to hear it.

285. With body, mind and words he worshipped [the Pandita's] feet,
circumambulated him and wept long.

286. Bowing to the lotus feet of Sri Gopinatha,
Srinivasa set out, having surrendered himself [to Him].

287. He went to Sri Jagannatha and had darshan,
and, weeping, offered many prayers.

288. Going to all the devotees who lived in the Kshetra,
he bows to them, rolling on the ground.

289. From both his eyes tears stream incessantly;
seeing his state, everyone's heart breaks.

290. In loving rapture all embrace him tightly;
no one can let Srinivasa go.

291. In distress all bade him farewell;
what they said cannot be described.

292. "Alas, alas! Let all his misfortunes fall on us!" —
so they all stood watching the road he took.[16]

293. Some went with him a little way
and found him good companions for the journey to Gauda.

294. "Srinivasa has gone to the land of Gauda,"
they all informed the Pandita Gosvami.

295. What became of him after he sent Srinivasa away —
how shall I tell it? Everyone was anxious.

296. Meanwhile Srinivasa thinks incessantly,
"Shall I ever again have the darshan of Sri Gosani?"

297. With many such fears, meditating on his feet,
he reached Khanda without mishap, though in great distress.

298. Seeing Srinivasa, Thakura Narahari
wept, clasping Srinivasa by the neck.

299. He carefully asks Srinivasa for news;
Srinivasa speaks, and tears stream from his eyes.

300. How the Lord's associates are in separation from the Lord —
this he cannot tell in detail, so troubled is his heart.

301. As he spoke about Pandita Gosani,
he fell unconscious on the ground.

302. Seeing Srinivasa's state, Prabhu Narahari
with great effort calmed him, holding him to his breast.

303. Sri Raghunandana and the other masters —
seeing Srinivasa, none of them could remain composed.

304. What happened there, how can I tell?
Sri Thakura Narahari calmed them all.

305. Srinivasa spent that night in Khanda,
and in the morning set out again on the road to the Kshetra.

306. He reflects, "Going to the Gosani,
this time I shall stay, even disobeying his order."

307. As such thoughts arose in his heart,
he saw some people coming from a distance.

308. Anxiously he asks them for news;
but who will say what? Everyone's heart is breaking.

309. At last, weeping, they said,
"Sri Pandita Gosvami has disappeared from sight."

310. Struck by these words as by a thunderbolt,
Srinivasa fell unconscious on the ground.

311. Seeing Srinivasa, all cry, "Alas, alas!
Why did we tell him this?"

312. One says, "When asked, one has to answer.
Now do whatever will keep him alive."

313. All in distress, tending Srinivasa,
brought him back to consciousness by various means.

314. Srinivasa looked at them,
strikes his head with his hand; his heart is bursting.

315. "Ha, ha, Prabhu Gadadhara!" he says again and again,
heaving long sighs, tears flowing from his eyes.

316. Now he says, "O Prabhu, you were merciless:
that is why you sent me, ignorant one, away!"

317. Much he says in this way, crying out in anguish;
hearing these words, even beasts and birds weep.

318. Late in the night, as his body lay motionless in sleep,
Gadadhara appeared to him in a dream and consoled him.

319. Even so Srinivasa cannot regain composure;
he weeps, crying, "Ha, ha, Prabhu Gaura, Gadadhara!"

320. Almost out of his mind, he wanders about near the village of Jajpur,[17]
not knowing how far he goes.

321. One day in a dream [Gadadhara], together with Gaura,
lovingly and carefully calmed Srinivasa:

322. "Go by way of Navadvipa quickly to Vrindavana."
So saying, the two disappeared.

323. On waking, Srinivasa could not compose himself,
and at daybreak he set out for the land of Gauda.

324. In loving rapture tears ceaselessly fall from his eyes;
whoever sees him even once cannot contain himself.

325. How wondrous was his going — alone he walks the highway!
Along that road some people were coming from Gauda.

326. Seeing Srinivasa, some say,
"We have heard — this is that very Srinivasa.

327. He is coming from Nilachala after only a short time,
and surely knows nothing of what has happened in Gauda."

328. Saying this, they all come near,
and Srinivasa carefully asks them,

329. "Where have you come from? Why are you so wasted?"
Again and again he asks, but gets no answer.

330. At last one, with downcast face, weeping, says,
"Nityananda and Advaita have both disappeared from sight."[18]

331. The moment he heard it, he flung himself to the ground
and resolved, "I will no longer keep life in this body."

332. Tearing his hair, he beats his head with his hands;
he weeps aloud — hearing it, even stones melt.

333. Crying, "What has happened, what has happened!" he tears his breast with his nails
and, raising his arms, says again and again:

334. "Ha, ha, Gaura, Nityananda, Advaita, Gadadhara!
Ha, ha, Svarupa, the Lord's second self!

335. To make one as fallen as I taste this sorrow
You caused me to be born on earth at the wrong time!

336. I shall do what is fitting, so that life leaves this body:
at daybreak I will kindle a fire and enter it."

337. Thus, burning in great grief, he spent the rest of the night;
by the Lord's will a little sleep overcame him.

338. And, as if in a dream, the merciful Nityananda and Advaita
came and appeared before Srinivasa.

339. How wondrous is Nitai's body, golden with a hue of red dawn:
it glitters, surpassing the morning sun.

340. A sweet loveliness steeped in the nectar of love;
before that youthful grace millions of Madanas fade.

341. How beautiful is His face, and on it a gentle smile,
like the radiance of millions of spotless moons.

342. On His head, lovely curls; on His forehead, a charming tilaka;
in His ears, earrings that glitter against His cheeks.

343. His brows a line of bees, His eyes broad lotuses,
His nose a parrot's beak, His teeth luscious kunda buds.

344. His broad chest — how sweet its majesty;
His arms, reaching to His knees, are the limit of beauty.

345. His navel, set with three folds, is deep and charming;
His slender waist dispels the pride of the lion.

346. His knees, like inverted plantain trunks, enchant the world;
the nupuras on His feet ring like a vina as He walks.

347. In His hand is a fine staff of gold and gems;
seeing Him even once, a heart of stone melts.

348. The beauty of Advaita Gosani is supremely lovely:
His enchanting body surpasses a golden mountain.

349. On His forehead is tilaka, on His neck a string of tulasi;
seeing His long eyes, Kama swoons.

350. His smiling face destroys the pride of the moon;
from the gleam of His teeth happiness seems to rain down.

351. His arms, reaching to His knees, surpass an elephant's trunk;
broad is His chest, and how slender His waist!

352. Incomparable His thighs, charming the sweetness of His feet;
seeing Him, the men and women of the world grow intoxicated.

353. Seeing two such Lords, Srinivasa
is bathed in tears, and his joy grows.

354. He fell prostrate at the feet of the two
and bathed the lotus feet of both with his tears.

355. Nitai and Advaita, both, seeing Srinivasa,
with joy in Their hearts bathed him in tears of love.

356. Stretching out Their arms, Their hearts full of tenderness,
They take Srinivasa in Their embrace and carefully console him:

357. "What you have resolved is not proper:
through this body of yours many tasks will be accomplished.

358. In Gauda many are longing to see you;
after seeing them all, go quickly to Vrindavana."

359. Saying much in this way, They calmed Srinivasa.
Again Srinivasa bowed to the Lords' feet.

360. They placed Their feet on Srinivasa's head and body
and with the greatest tenderness embraced him again.

361. Having sent Srinivasa off, the two
at that very moment disappeared [with Their] bodies.

362. On waking, Srinivasa was overcome with distress,
and at daybreak he set out from there.

363. In a few days he passed the border of Utkala
and by way of Madhya-desha entered the land of Gauda.[19]

364. What happened when he went to Khanda and saw the Lord's dear ones —
that I cannot describe.

365. Remembering the order Sri Prabhu had given in the dream,
he set off on the road to Navadvipa.

366. Hearing news of Nadia from people,
he cannot restrain himself: tears stream from his eyes.

367. On the way to Navadvipa his anxiety keeps growing:
a two days' journey he walks in one.

368. What arose in his heart as he went along the road —
who could describe it with one mouth?

369. Such is this journey of Sri Srinivasa to Nadia:
whoever hears it obtains the treasure of bhakti.

370. Meditating on the feet of Srinivasa Acharya,
Narahari Dasa tells the Bhakti-ratnakara.

Thus in the Sri Bhakti-ratnakara, in the account of the life of Srinivasa Acharya, ends the third wave, called "His Journey to Nilachala and Return to Gauda".

1. "My Sri Thakura" — apparently the author's guru (so also in the editions of 1888 and 1912/13).

2. CC Antya 19.20–21 — Advaita's riddle (tarja), conveyed to the Lord by Jagadananda; its meaning is deliberately obscure. "Baul" means "madman", "aul" — "confusion, madness".

3. The Nava-padya ("Nine Verses") of Nrisimha Kaviraja is a work on Srinivasa; Narahari quotes other verses from it further on.

4. Narendra-sarovara in Puri, where the Lord and His devotees held water-sports (cf. CC). The explanation of the name from King Narendra and the minister Shaucha is Narahari's.

5. Markandeya-sarovara is a sacred pond in Puri.

6. "Prabhu-agochara" — literally "beyond the reach of the Lord": Gadadhara's state in separation is so deep that it is unfathomable even to the Lord Himself (a usual intensification in Bengali poetry).

7. According to the CC (Adi 10 and elsewhere), Raghunatha Dasa lived in Puri under Svarupa Damodara for sixteen years; after the departure of the Lord and of Svarupa he went to Vrindavana, to Rupa and Sanatana, at Radha-kunda.

8. Chaitanya-chandrodaya-nataka of Kavi-karnapura, Act 10, verse 3. Raghunatha Dasa's preceptor Yadunandana Acharya was a disciple of Vasudeva Datta (CC Antya 6).

9. So Narahari: Prataparudra supposedly handed power to his son and withdrew from affairs while the Lord was still present. According to historical records he continued to reign after 1533 (until about 1540).

10. The samadhi of Haridasa Thakura on the seashore at Puri; Haridasa's departure and his burial by the Lord Himself are described in CC Antya 11.

11. Patita-pavana ("Purifier of the fallen") — the form of Jagannatha at the Lion Gate (Simha-dvara) of the Puri temple, visible to all who cannot enter the temple.

12. The silver mountain is Kailasa; the comparisons stress Balarama's whiteness.

13. Chakra-beda — the circular enclosure (inner courtyard) of the Jagannatha temple, where the smaller shrines stand.

14. The book of the Srimad-Bhagavata from which Gadadhara Pandita read to the Lord; according to tradition, its pages were soaked with the tears of both.

15. Gadadhara Dasa — an associate of the Lord (not to be confused with Gadadhara Pandita); he lived in Bengal, at Eriadaha on the Ganges; in the CB (Antya 5) he is a companion of Nityananda. The Pandita apparently grieves at being separated from him.

16. "Mari mari snehera balai laiya mari" — an exclamation of tenderness: "let us die taking all his misfortunes upon ourselves."

17. Jajpur — a holy place in Orissa on the Vaitarani river, on the road from Puri to Bengal.

18. In Narahari's account Gadadhara Pandita, Nityananda and Advaita disappeared soon after the Lord, while Srinivasa was on the road. Traditions about the time of Nityananda's and Advaita's departure differ; Narahari follows his own version.

19. Utkala is Orissa. Madhya-desha ("the middle country") here apparently means the region between Orissa and Gauda (Midnapore).